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सेवा से समर्पण
२५ वर्ष
शुभेच्छुक : एकनाथ शिंदे उपमुख्यमंत्री महाराष्ट्र

गौरव अभियान

Seva Se Samarpan



The Pride of India,
Visionary Prime Minister
Hon'ble Shri.
Narendra Modi ji

Heartiest congratulations



-: Well-wisher :-

शिवसेना

Eknath Sambhaji Shinde
Deputy Chief Minister, Maharashtra



The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY | OCTOBER 7, 2026

SIR row: INDIA bloc march chokes Lutyens' traffic

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi


INDIA bloc supporters were detained during the alliance's protest march from Parliament to the Election Commission of India, while media personnel and supporters surrounded the vehicle in New Delhi PTI

Barricades, diversions and security restrictions turned key roads in Lutyens' Delhi into long stretches of slow-moving traffic on Tuesday, as the INDIA bloc's march towards the Election Commission disrupted movement across the New Delhi and Central Delhi area.

From India Gate and Connaught Place to Parliament Street and Jantar Mantar, bumper-to-bumper traffic built up on several stretches, with vehicles inching forward amid diversions and intermittent stoppages. At several points, long queues spilled back onto adjoining roads as motorists struggled to find alternate routes through the heavily barricaded area.

The congestion left commuters stranded for prolonged periods, with several saying they were stuck for at least three to four hour. Some commuters abandoned their vehicles and switched to the Metro or walked to reach destinations in central Delhi, while visuals showed vehicles packed tightly along stretches affected by the restrictions.

Traffic was severely affected on the Connaught Place, Patel Chowk, Rafi Marg, Parliament Street stretch, Motilal Nehru Marg, Teen Murti Marg, Prithviraj Road, Windsor Place, Ashoka Road, and Jantar Mantar Road.

"Traffic was moving at almost zero speed and the queue barely moved. We were stuck for nearly an hour before some of us decided to get down and take the Metro instead," a commuter stuck on Ashoka Road said.

Traffic was also affected across the New Delhi area, with movement hit on Krishna Menon Marg, Rajpath and Circular Road, while heavy congestion was reported at several roundabouts around India Gate. Another commuter reported a complete traffic jam from Mori Gate roundabout towards Hamilton Road and Pul Dufferin rail over bridge.

Another commuter said roads around India Gate were heavily congested, with restrictions and diversions on several routes making it difficult to move between adjoining areas.

"The entire road near the Taj and Marriott was blocked for VIP movement and thousands of vehicles were left stuck. There was heavy barricading and no easy way through," the commuter said.

The police also said restrictions around the Taj and Marriott hotels were linked to VIP/VVIP movements and were imposed according to operational and security requirements.

"We understand the concern regarding traffic restrictions in the vicinity of Taj and Marriott hotels and the resulting congestion. Traffic regulation during VIP/VVIP movements is undertaken as per operational and security requirements and efforts are made to keep such restrictions need-based and for the minimum possible duration," the police said.

The disruption followed special traffic arrangements put in place from 8 am for the INDIA bloc march from Parliament Street to the ECI headquarters to protest against the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

The Delhi Traffic Police said vehicular movement was being regulated or diverted on several key roads in and around Connaught Place, Patel Chowk, Parliament Street and Jantar Mantar.

Commuters have been advised to avoid unnecessary journeys through Jantar Mantar, Parliament Street, Ashoka Road and adjoining areas and expect diversions, barricading and congestion. Traffic personnel remain deployed at critical points to manage diversions and ease congestion, with normal movement being restored progressively after the completion of the movements, police said.

ACP seeks hold on promotion amid journalist harassment inquiry

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Assistant Commissioner of Police (ACP) Vivek Bhagat, who has been accused of sexually harassing a woman journalist during a protest here, has written to the Delhi Police chief requesting that the order assigning him the current duty charge of additional DCP be kept on hold in view of an inquiry pending against him in the Crime Branch.

In his letter dated October 5, Bhagat said his current duty charge as additional DCP had been approved through an order issued earlier in the day.

"However, considering the enquiry pending against me in the Crime Branch Delhi Police regarding allegations against me by a YouTuber, I hereby give my consent to keep this order concerning only me on hold," he said in the letter addressed to the Commissioner of Police Anurag Kumar.

Bhagat, who is posted as Sub-Divisional Police Officer (SDPO) Connaught Place, signed the letter and requested that the order concerning him alone be kept on hold.

The development comes a day after the Delhi Government said Bhagat's current duty charge as additional DCP would be withheld after he requested "of his own volition" not to avail the charge until a full inquiry into the alleged harassment of women journalists is conducted and "satisfactorily concluded".

Bhagat was among 12 DANIPS officers assigned the current duty charge of additional DCP on Monday. The Government subsequently said the earlier order would be modified and reissued for assignment of the charge to the remaining 11 officers.

The Government had also clarified that the proposal to confer the additional duty charge on the 12 officers, including Bhagat, was initiated on August 25, "much before the present set of events", and the orders were issued after due approval on October 5.

Bhagat's promotion was part of the routine process linked to his service and was not connected to the ongoing protests. However, the decision drew sharp criticism for the timing of the development due to the ongoing harassment allegations against him.

Cops get bodycams for frontline duty amid protest misconduct allegations

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Amid allegations of excesses by security personnel during protests, Delhi Police has issued body-worn cameras to its officers and personnel deployed on the frontline across the New Delhi area, an official source said on Tuesday.

The bodycams have been issued to officers deployed across the New Delhi area, particularly those involved in crowd management and security arrangements around protest sites and roads leading to the Election Commission of India office, the source said.

A police source said the bodycams would help maintain a real-time video record of events and interactions between police personnel and protesters, besides providing evidence in case allegations are made against officers on duty.

"The bodycams are important, particularly when officers are dealing with large crowds, and there are allegations from either side. The recordings can help establish what happened during a protest," the source said.

The move comes amid heightened security in the New Delhi, Central Delhi and North Delhi districts following a series of demonstrations against the Election Commission over the SIR exercise. Police and paramilitary personnel have been deployed in large numbers, while multilayer barricades have been placed at several points to prevent protesters from entering restricted areas.

The deployment of bodycams assumes significance following complaints of alleged sexual harassment and manhandling made by three women journalists during a protest against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar at Jantar Mantar on October 2.

SAR TELEVENTURE LIMITED
CIN: L45202UP2019PLC213062
Regd.Office: B-16, First Floor, Sector-2, Noida-201301, Uttar Pradesh
Mobile No: +91-8587050050
E-mail: info@sarteleventure.com, **Website:** www.sarteleventure.com

Notice of Postal Ballot

Members of the Company are hereby informed that pursuant to Section 108, 110 and other applicable provisions, if any, of the Companies Act, 2013 (**"the Act"**) read with Rule 20 and 22 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014 (**"the Rules"**), read with the General Circular No. 03/2025 dated 22nd September 2025 issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (**"MCA"**), read together with previous circulars issued by MCA in this regard (**"MCA Circulars"**), applicable provisions of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 (**"Listing Regulations"**), the Company has on Tuesday, 6th October, 2026 sent e-mails to all those Members whose e-mail addresses are registered with the Company/Registrar and Share Transfer Agent/Depository Participants containing the Postal Ballot Notice dated 1st October, 2026 (**"Postal Ballot Notice"**) along with Explanatory Statement thereto seeking their approval for the following proposals only by way of remote e-voting process:

ITEM NO. 1: APPROVAL FOR DISINVESTMENT / SALE OF 1,28,09,761 EQUITY SHARES, REPRESENTING 90.82% OF THE EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF FUSIONNET WEB SERVICES LIMITED TO TIKONA COMMUNICATION LIMITED (PREVIOUSLY KNOWN AS GRAND FOUNDRY LIMITED)- SPECIAL RESOLUTION

In line with the MCA Circulars, the Postal Ballot Notice has been sent only through electronic mode to all those Members who have registered their email address with the Company's Registrar and Share Transfer Agent (RTA) i.e. M/s. MUFG Intime India Private Limited (**"MUFG"**) and Depository Participants as on **Friday, 2nd October, 2026** (**"Cut-Off Date"**). Please note that physical copy of the Notice, Postal Ballot Form and pre-paid business reply envelope have not been sent to the Members for this Postal Ballot. The Company has engaged the services of MUFG for providing remote e-voting facilities to the eligible Members, to enable them to cast their vote electronically.

The E-voting period commences from Wednesday, October 7, 2026, at 9:00 A.M. (IST) and ends on Thursday, November 5, 2026 at 05:00 P.M. (IST) (**both days inclusive**). During this period, the Members of the Company, holding shares either in physical form or in demat form, as on the Cut-Off Date may cast their vote electronically. The e-voting module shall be disabled by MUFG for voting thereafter and the voting shall not be allowed beyond the said date and time. Once the vote on a Resolution is cast by the Member, the Member shall not be allowed to change it subsequently.

Members holding shares as on the Cut-Off Date whose e-mail addresses are not registered with the Company/RTA/Depositories/Depository Participants may request for the Postal Ballot Notice by sending an e-mail to info@sarteleventure.com or enotices@in.mpms.mufg.com to receive Postal Ballot Notice or download from the website of the Company i.e. www.sarteleventure.com and can vote electronically by following the procedure and instructions for remote e-voting provided in the Postal Ballot Notice.

In case the shareholders have any queries or issues regarding e-voting, they may refer the Frequently Asked Questions ("FAQs") and Instavote e-Voting manual available at https://instavote.linkintime.co.in, under "Help" section. Any grievances connected with remote e-voting, the same may be addressed to MUFG Intime India Private Limited, (INSTAVOTE) at helpdesk Email ID: enotices@in.mpms.mufg.com or call on: 022 – 49186000. Members may also contact Mr. Mayank Jain, Company Secretary & Compliance Officer of the Company, by sending an e-mail to info@sarteleventure.com.

Individual Shareholders holding securities in demat mode for any technical issues related to login through Depository may contact (i) NSDL by sending a request at evoting@nsdl.co.in or call at toll free no.: 022 - 4886 7000; (ii) CDSL by sending a request at helpdesk.evoting@cdslindia.com or contact at 1800 22 55 33.

Ms. Loveleen Gupta, Proprietor of M/s. L. Gupta & Associates, Practicing Company Secretaries (Membership No. FCS 5287), has been appointed as the Scrutinizer to conduct the Postal Ballot activity through remote e-voting process in fair and transparent manner. The results of the remote e-voting will be declared within two working days from the conclusion of the remote e-voting period and shall be placed along with the Scrutinizer's Report on the website of the Company at www.sarteleventure.com and submitted to the Stock Exchange, i.e. National Stock Exchange of India Limited, at www.nseindia.com.

Reminder to update PAN, KYC and Bank details, Choice of Nomination, email address etc.:

In case you have not yet updated your PAN, KYC details, Bank Account information, Nomination, Email address, etc., or if you wish to modify or change any of the aforementioned details, kindly take the following action based on your mode of shareholding:

1. **For shares held in dematerialized form:** Please contact your respective Depository Participant (DP) to update or modify your details.
2. **For shares held in physical form:** Kindly write to the Company's Registrar and Share Transfer Agent (RTA) at the following address:

MUFG Intime India Pvt. Ltd.
Unit: SAR Televenture Limited
C-101, 247 Park, L.B.S. Marg,
Vikhroli (West), Mumbai - 400 083
Email ID: enotices@in.mpms.mufg.com
call on: 022 – 49186000.

By Order of the Board of Directors of
SAR Televenture Limited
Sd/-
Mayank Jain
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer
Membership No.: A26620

Place : Noida (U.P.)
Date : October 6, 2026

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given that SUSHIL KUMAR, S/o Late Shri Bal Krishna, is applying to Noida Authority for the Death Mutation of Property No: C298/B, Sector-19, Noida, originally allotted to my late brother Shri Satish Kumar Kansal died on 20.08.2026. In my brother's documents, our late father's name is recorded as "BAL Krishan", BAL Krishna", and BAL KRISHNA KANSAL". All these three names belong to one and the same person, i.e., my late father. I am the sole natural legal heir. Objections, if any, may be submitted in writing to the Estate Office, Noida Authority, Sector-96, Noida, within 30 days of this notice.

SH. SUSHIL KUMAR

PUBLIC NOTICE

My Client Smt. Kamla Devi, W/o Late Shri Bal Krishan, R/o H.No. 142, Village Mohammadpur, South-West Delhi-110066, hereby inform that I hasve disowned my son Lalit Kumar from all my movable/immovable self-acquired properties and severed all relations with him due to his behaviour. Anyone dealing with him shall do so at their own risk. I shall not be responsible for his any acts or liabilities.

Adarsh Kumar Dubey
Advocate for Kamla Devi

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is to inform to the public at large that Mr. Ajay Chawla and Mrs. Mamta Chawla had acquired Agricultural land measuring 2 Bighas and 1 Biswa Comprised in Khasra No.487 Min (0-6), 481 (0-9), 480 Min (1-0) 488 (0-6) situated in the revenue estate of Village Fatehpur Beri Tehsil Mehrauli New Delhi, vide Sale Deed dt. 10.10.2024 executed by Mrs. Nitasha Arora. Original Sale deed dt. 17.09.2021 executed in favour of Mrs. Nitasha Arora, Doc no.7075 is Lost. Now Mr. Ajay Chawla and Mrs. Mamta Chawla are the undisputed owners of above said property and willing to Mortgage the above said property with Hero Fincrop Limited.

OR

Any person / firm / institution / company having any claim or right in respect of the said Property by way of inheritance, share, sale, agreement, lease, license, gift, possession, legal heirs, partners or encumbrance howsoever or otherwise is hereby required to intimate in writing to the undersigned within 07 days from the date of publication of this notice of his/her/their share or claim, if any, with all supporting documents at below mentioned address. After expiration of notice period, the claims, if any, of such person shall be treated null and void and also treated as waived and not binding on our client.

Ajay Kumar Giri (Advocate) H No. 26/161, Basement, Vikram Vihar, Lajpat Nagar 4, New Delhi -110024

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is to inform to the public at large that Mrs. Amritika Phool and Mr. Tejbir Singh Gujral had acquired Land measuring 12 Biswa, Must. No. 35, Killa no. 9 Min (0-12), at Village Dera Mandi, Tehsil Mehrauli, New Delhi. vide Sale Deed dt. 05.06.2026 executed by Mr. Rakesh Kumar, who had acquire the said property vide Sale Deed dt. 06.01.2026 executed by (1) Mr. I.E Soomar (2) Mrs. Z.I Soomar through attorney Mr. Dilip Kumar. Now Mrs. Amritika Phool and Mr. Tejbir Singh Gujral are the undisputed owners of above said property and willing to Mortgage the above said property with CIFCL.

OR

Any person / firm / institution / company having any claim or right in respect of the said Property by way of inheritance, share, sale, agreement, lease, license, gift, possession, legal heirs, partners or encumbrance howsoever or otherwise is hereby required to intimate in writing to the undersigned within 07 days from the date of publication of this notice of his/her/their share or claim, if any, with all supporting documents at below mentioned address. After expiration of notice period, the claims, if any, of such person shall be treated null and void and also treated as waived and not binding on our client.

Ajay Kumar Giri (Advocate) H No. 26/161, Basement, Vikram Vihar, Lajpat Nagar 4, New Delhi -110024

Bank of Baroda, Parliament Street Branch, 16 Sansad Marg, New Delhi

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform the general public that **BANK OF BARODA,** Parliament Street Branch, 16, Sansad Marg, New Delhi 110001 intends to accept the undermentioned property standing in the name of **Mr. Gopinath Menon s/o Mr K S Menon r/o Apartment no 1202A, Beverly Park II, M.G.Road Metro Station, DLF Phase II, Chakarpur (74), DLF Qe, Gurgaon, Haryana 122002 and Mrs Poonam Menon Apartment no 1202A, Beverly Park II, M.G.Road Metro Station, DLF Phase II, Chakarpur (74), DLF Qe, Gurgaon, Haryana 122002,** as security for a loan/credit facility requested by one of its customers- M/S ITN Exports.

In case anyone has got any right/title/interest/claims over the undermentioned property, they are advised to approach the Bank within 10 days along with necessary proof to substantiate their claim.

If no response is received within 10 days, it is presumed that the property is free of any charge/claim/encumbrance and Bank shall proceed with the mortgage.

Details of the property:- **Residential Property bearing No A-1202, Type Sterling on 2nd Floor in multi storeyed block no. XII known as Beverly Park II in the residential colony known as DLF City Phase II, at village Sarhaul, Tehsil & Dist. Gurgaon.**

Branch Details: Bank of Baroda, Parliament Street Branch, 16 Sansad Marg, New Delhi

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NEW OKHLA INDUSTRIAL DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
Main Administrative Building, Sector-96, Noida, G.B. Nagar (U.P.)
Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tender are invited from firms/contractors registered with UPLC Lucknow for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official website: **www.noidaauthorityonline.in** & **https://etender.up.nic.in**. Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/ amendments & corrigendum etc.

(A)

(1)	**79/S.M.-JAL-I/E.T./2026-27,** Development and Maintenance of Village (Raising of Manhole Cover Frame due to C/o New Cement Concrete Road in Village-Mamura), Noida. Cost Rs. 49.45 Lacs
(2)	**80/S.M.-JAL-I/E.T./2026-27,** M/o Sewerages (Two year Repairing Cleaning of Sewer Manhole and P/F Manhole Cover Frame Kunda Colony, Rajeev Colony, Jeetram Colony, Baba Colony, Bhatta Colony, Shiv Vihar Colony, Goyal Colony in Village Bhangel and Salarpur), Noida. Cost Rs. 87.19 Lacs
(3)	**17/S.M.(GANGAJAL)/E.T./2026-27,** M/o Gangajal (Two Year Repairing of D.G. Sets & other Misc. work at Gangajal UGRs in Sector-65, 72, 51, 118 (M1), 69 (M2 & M3) Noida. Cost Rs. 95.89 Lacs

Which can be uploaded by **date:- 21.10.2026 upto 5.00 PM.** Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on **date:- 22.10.2026 at 11.00 AM.**

(B)

(1)	**26/S.M.(Jal)-II/E.T./2026-27,** M/o Sewerage (Searching, Raising, Cleaning and Functional of Sewer Line in Sector-150), Noida. Cost Rs. 66.25 Lacs.
(2)	**27/S.M.(Jal)-II/E.T./2026-27,** Internal Development of Water Works Compound (Repair, Maintenance, Painting Work and other various works in Ranney Well-10 Compound Sector-164), Noida. Cost Rs. 92.25 Lacs.

Which can be uploaded by **date:- 14.10.2026 upto 5.00 PM.** Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on **date:- 15.10.2026 at 11.00 AM.**

General Manager (Jal)
NOIDA

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

Bank of Baroda, Parliament Street Branch, 16 Sansad Marg, New Delhi

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform the general public that **BANK OF BARODA,** Parliament Street Branch, 16, Sansad Marg, New Delhi 110001 intends to accept the undermentioned property standing in the name of **Mr. Uma Rani Tandon s/o Mr Rajpal Tandon Mr Vinay Tandon s/o Rajpal Tandon, & Mrs Priyanka Tandon w/o Vijay Tandon r/o Apartment no H- No L-4/8, Road No L/04, Phase II, DLF Qutab Enclave Complex II, Gurugram Haryana,** as security for a loan/credit facility requested by one of its customers- M/S Tandon Trading Co.

In case anyone has got any right/title/interest/claims over the undermentioned property, they are advised to approach the Bank within 10 days along with necessary proof to substantiate their claim.

If no response is received within 10 days, it is presumed that the property is free of any charge/claim/encumbrance and Bank shall proceed with the mortgage.

Details of the property:- **Residential Property bearing H- No L-4/8, Road No L/04, Phase II, DLF Qutab Enclave Complex II, Gurugram Haryana**

Boundaries : East- House No L-04/07, West- House No L-04/09, North- House No L-03/27, South- 12 mtr Wide Road

Branch Details: Bank of Baroda, Parliament Street Branch, 16 Sansad Marg, New Delhi

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SMFG India Home Finance Co. Ltd.
SMFG Grihashakti — Nayi Asha. Naya Vishwas.
Corporate Off. : 503 & 504, 5th Floor, G-Block, Inspire BKC, BKC Main Road, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai - 400051.
Regd. Off. : Commerzone IT Park, Tower B, 1st Floor, No. 111, Mount Poonamallee Road, Porur, Chennai – 600116, TN

POSSESSION NOTICE FOR IMMOVABLE PROPERTY [(Appendix IV) Rule 8(1)]

WHEREAS the undersigned being the **Authorized Officer** of **SMFG India Home Finance Co. Ltd.** a Housing Finance Company [duly registered with National Housing Bank (Fully Owned by RBI)] (hereinafter referred to as "SMHFC") under Secuitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assests and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (54 of 2002), and in exercise of the powers conferred under Section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 issued Demand Notice dated mentioned below under Section 13(2) of the said Act calling upon you being the borrowers (names mentioned below) to repay the amount mentioned in the said notice and interest thereon **within 60 days** from the date of receipt of the said notice. The borrowers mentioned herein below having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrowers mentioned herein below and to the public in general that the undersigned has **Taken Possession** of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on me under sub-section (4) of Section 13 of the Act read with Rule 8 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. The borrowers mentioned here in above in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with said property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of **"SMHFC"** for an amount as mentioned herein under and interest thereon.

Sl. No.	Name of the Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) LAN	Description of Secured Assets (Immovable Property)	Demand Notice Date & Amount	Date of Possession
1.	**Lan :- 609139211285857 & 613939511767416 1. Nisha Manu Dev 2. Poonam Manu Dev**	Built Up Property Bearing Plot No.c-45 Second Floor Without Roof Rights Towards Left Side Area Measuring 73.25 Sq Yards 61.25 Sq Meater Out Of Khasra No. 336/ Situated In The Revenue Estate Of Village Bindapur Delhi State Area Abadi Konown As Colony Subhash Park Uttam Nagar New Delhi 110059	**23.07.2026 Rs. 27,06,690.07 (RS. Twenty-Seven Lakh Six Thousand Six Hundred Ninety & Seven Paise only) as on 23.07.2026**	**06.10.2026**
2.	**Lan :- 613738311710070 & 613738011710037 1. Amar Kumar** S/o. Shashi Bhushan Singh **2. Nidhi Kumari** C/o. Shashi Bhushan Singh	Residential Plot Bearing No. 39 Area Measuring 100 Sq Yards I.e 83.61 Square Meter Out Of Khasra No. 606 Situated At Colony Ashok Vihar Near Green Residency In The Area Of Village Chipiyana Bujurg T Near Railway Line Pargana And Tehsil Dadri District Gautam Budh Nagar Boundaries:- **East-** Plot No.45, **West.** Road 22f-T, **North-** Plot No.40, **South.** Hovse No.38	**17-06-2026 Rs. 39,60,111.53 (RS. Thirty Nine Lakh Sixty Thousand One Hundred Eleven Fifty Three) as on 17-06-2026**	**06.10.2026**
3.	**Lan :- 613939211798246 1. Mohd Atif** S/o. Bhurey Khan **2. Fatma Begum** W/o. Bhurey Khan	Second Floor Without Roof Rights A Part Of Bearing Built-Up Property No. A. 1/86 Old No. A-203 Bearing Built Up Floor Carpet Area 95.31 Mtrs 114 Sq Yards) In Part Of Khasra 934/ 125 Situated At In The Abadi Of Main Texla Road Kabir Nagar And In The Area Of Village Sikdarpur And Ilaqa Shahdra Delhi-110094 Boundaries:- **East-**Entry/Road 20 Ft Wide, **West-**Property Of Others, **North.** Property Of Others, **South.** Property Or Others	**17-06-2026 Rs. 52,77,523.68 (Rs. Fifty Lakh Seventy Seven Thousand Five Hundred Twenty & Paige Sixty Eight Only) as on 17-06-2026**	**06.10.2026**
4.	**Lan :- 605439211738314 1. Pankaj Kumar** S/o. Shri Chand Singh Adi **2. Jyoti Pankaj Kumar,** S/o. Shri Chand Singh Adi	Flat No Ugf.01 Upper Ground Floor Front Side Rhs Without Roof Total Area Measuring 322 Square Feet I.e 29.91 Square Meter Built On Plot No B-2s Khasra No 216 Situated In Rail Vihar Avas Samiti Ltd Hadbast Village Sadullabad Tehsil Loni Distt Ghaziabad **East-**Entry/Stairs, **West.** Rasta 2s Ft Wide, **North.** Plat No. Ugf 2, **South-** Plot No. B 26	**17-06-2026 Rs. 12,29,846.83/- (Rs. Twelve Lakh TwentyNine Thousand Eight Hundred FortySix & Paise EightyThree Only) as on 17.06.2026.**	**06.10.2026**
5.	**Lan :- 609139212053364 1. Raman Sharma** S/o. Bhawan Sharma **2. Kalpana Shrma** W/o. Raman Sharma	Entire Upper Ground Floor Without Roof/Terrace Rights Which Ia A Part Of Built Up Property Bearing 1800, Built On Land Area Measuring 7s Sq Yards For Say 62.71 Square Meater Portion Of Plot No.18 Out Of Khasra No. 524/315,535/315 Situated The Area Of Village Saleempur Mazra Maidpur Delhi State Delhi Abadi Known As Rani Bagh Shakur Basti Delhi 110034 **East.** Plot No. 1801, **West** Others Property, **North.** other Property, **South-** Gali 10 Feet Wide.	**23-07-2026 Rs. 40,47,718.72/- (Rs. Forty Lakh Forty Seven Thousand Seven Hundred Eighteen & Paise Seventy Two) as on 23.07.2026**	**06.10.2026**
6.	**Lan :- 620638011888764 1. Rohit Pandey (Borrower) (Through Legal Heir Of Deceased Borrower) Shikha Dubey Ico-Borrower & Legal Heir) W/o. Rohit Pandey 2. Shikha Dubey (Co. borrower & Legal Heir),**	Property Area Measuring 5o Square Yards I.e 41.805 Square Meater Situated At Plot No 122 Aa Khasra No. 402 Block A Indrapuri Extn Colony Harbdast Village Gharoti Khurd Pargna And Tehsil Loni District Ghaziabad	**17-06-2026 Rs. 16,24,992.58/- (RS. Sixteen Twenty Four Thousand Nine Hundred Ninety TWO & Paise Fifty Eight) as on 17-06-2026**	**06.10.2026**
7.	**Lan :- 609139211766339 1. Saurabh Verma** S/o. Raj Kumar Verma **2. Mitlesh Verma** W/o. Raj Kumar Verma **3. Raj Kumar Verma** S/o. Ram Sharan Dass	Residential Flat No.pf.oi Mig First Floor Pront Lhs Side Without Roof Rights Area Measuring 700 Sq Feet I.e 65.03 Sq Meters On Plot No. A.8/3 Dlf Ankur Vihar Hadbast Village Loni Pargana Tehsil Distt Ghaziabad Boundaries:- **East-**Flat No. ".02 / Plot No Plot No. A.8/4 **North.** Entry And Flat No.ff-04, **South-**Road	**22-05-2026 Rs. 16,28,250.36/- (Rs. Sixteen Lakh Twenty-Eight Thousand TWO Hundred Fifty & Paise ThirtySix Only) as on 22-05-2026**	**06.10.2026**

Sd/-
Authorized Officer,
SMFG INDIA HOME FINANCE CO. LTD.

Place : Delhi/ Ghaziabad, Gautam Budh Nagar, Uttar Pradesh
Date : 06.10.2026

PUBLIC NOTICE

Public at large is hereby informed that Freehold Entire Second Floor, Without Roof/Terrace Rights, Property No. 135, Area Measuring 251.9 Sq. Yds. The Delhi Bengali Hindu CHBS Ltd. Known as Tagore Park, Delhi, presently owned by Sh. Ravinder Kumar by virtue of Sale Deed duly registered vide Regd. No.1976, dated 15.02.2016 and the same is proposed to be offered as Security with State Bank of India, Branch : Home Loan Centre, Central, Thapar House, New Delhi and as per present owner(s) version the said property is/are free from all sorts of encumbrance., and (1) ORIGINAL Perpetual Sub-Lease Deed executed by in favor of Sh. Munshi Ram, Regd. No. 1990, dated 17.12.1968 (2) ORIGINAL Mortgage Deed executed by President of India in favour of Munshi Ram, Regd No. 5734, dated 29.08.1969 (3) ORIGINAL GPA, ATS both dated 09.01.1970 executed by Shri Munshi Ram in favour of Shri Bhola Nath (4) ORIGINAL GPA, ATS both dated 15.01.2000 executed by Shri Bhola Nath in favour of Smt. Sharda Taneja (5) ORIGINAL Conveyance Deed executed in favour of Smt. Sharda Taneja, Regd No. 12240, dated 03.11.2000, (6) ORIGINAL GPA executed by Smt. Sharda Taneja in favour of Shri Shashi Dhar and Smt. Sudha Dawar, Regd. No.15795, dt.10.09.2001 & ORIGINAL SPA & ATS both dated 10.09.2001 executed by Smt. Sharda Taneja in favour of Shri Shashi Dhar & Smt. Sudha Dawar, is/are reported as lost vide LR No. 699124/2026. dated 06.10.2026 with E police station Mukherjee Nagar, North West District, Delhi Police, Delhi.

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SATYENDER YADAV (Advocate)
Ch.No.561, 5th Floor, Saket Courts, New Delhi.
M. 9711212421, Email: satender175@gmail.com

PUBLIC NOTICE

Reg: Plot Bearing No. 330, area measuring 172 sq. yds., situated at Sector 48, in the Urban Estate, Faridabad, Haryana; hereinafter referred to as "said property"

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Shivkant Arora, Advocate
M/s Intellective Law Offices
A-74, LGF, Defence Colony,
New Delhi -110024

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Day of detention ends with Rahul, Priyanka release at night

Congress leaders, 250 others detained after being denied march to Nirvachan Sadan

ABHINAV KUMAR JHA
New Delhi

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi and other party leaders who were detained after an over eight-hour sit-in at Akashvani Bhawan in the national Capital were released by the Delhi Police around 10.20 pm, almost three hours after the protesting MPs were detained around 7.30 pm on Tuesday.

Rahul Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra were among 250 people Delhi Police detained Tuesday evening after they stopped an over eight-hour sit-in protest inside the Akashvani Bhawan premises when they were stopped from marching towards the Nirvachan Sadan. Around 50 MPs were among the detainees, police sources said. The detainees were taken to New Police Lines at Kingsway Camp and then released late evening.

During his detention, Rahul took to social media to express his annoyance and stated: "To save the traitors of democracy, the remnants of democracy



Rahul Gandhi is detained by police after an over eight-hour sit-in at Akashvani Bhawan, following the denial of permission to march to the Election Commission's office during a protest against CEC Gyanesh Kumar in New Delhi on Tuesday PTI

have been dragged through the mud. There will be a reckoning — not a single traitor will be spared".

Police forcibly removed Rahul Gandhi, along with Congress MPs and leaders including KC Venugopal, Pawan Khera, K Suresh, Amarinder Singh, Raja Warring and Imran Pratapgarhi, as the Akashvani premises were cleared of protesting MPs. Rahul had earlier entered the Akashvani premises on Parliament Street and started a *dharna* after police thwarted an attempt by Opposition MPs to march towards the Election Commission office, located around 300 metres away.

The Opposition MPs were protesting over "vote chori" in the wake of reports alleging irregularities in the functioning of the Election Commission of India (ECI) and the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. The sit-in continued for more than eight hours before police began clearing the premises and detaining protesters.

From climbing barricades to sitting in Akashvani Bhawan, the INDIA bloc protest led by Congress occupied the centre stage of the Opposition's street protest, forcing a total lockdown of Parliament Street and leading to a massive traffic jam in central parts of Delhi, as Rahul tried to march towards the Election Commission's office nearby with hundreds of supporters and other Opposition MPs.

At one point, buoyed by onlookers' cheers, he climbed atop multi-layer steel barricades, stood on them, and waved the Tricolour before slipping through the police cordons to sneak into the premises of All India Radio.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

BJP accuses Opposition of fomenting anarchy

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Hitting back at the INDIA bloc protest led by Congress leader Rahul Gandhi, the BJP on Tuesday accused the Opposition of fomenting anarchy and said the marchers are "venting their frustration" over their electoral defeats by levelling baseless allegations against the constitutional bodies to malign their image. The



BJP said the Congress is relaunching Rahul Gandhi.

"The reality is that Rahul Gandhi is a *kaamchor*(slacker) and he is levelling allegations of 'vote-chori'," party spokesperson Sudhanshu Trivedi charged, adding, "How many times has Rahul ever camped in a poll-bound State for at least one week or two weeks and campaigned for his party?" Addressing a press conference at the BJP headquarters, Trivedi slammed the Opposition for "theatrics on the streets" and asked the Congress whom it wants to benefit by demanding voting rights without verification.

FULL REPORT >> P4

Delhi Police face sustained protest pressure

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH New Delhi

Delhi is the national political centre, and every party strives to convey its message nationwide, whether through demonstrations or protests. In the era of instant information, managing these events is challenging, and the Delhi Police, of late, is getting tested relentlessly.

Starting with the Jantar Mantar protests in June, the tempo has not abated. The latest challenge began on October 2 with the Opposition demonstrating against the Election Commission of India (ECI) and continued on Tuesday.

There is no let-up, with more such protests lined up for the next few days. Political parties



in Delhi have often used major protest sites and central roads to share their message. Now, with instant video and live updates, every police cordon, roadblock, or detention is seen as it happens.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

The ByStander



PIONEER IN SHORT

TREMORS FELT ACROSS DELHI-NCR

Tremors were felt in Delhi and adjoining areas late Tuesday after a 4.9-magnitude earthquake hit Uttarakhand's Chamoli district. According to the National Center for Seismology (NCS) — the nodal Government agency monitoring earthquake activity — the epicentre was located at a depth of 13 km in Uttarakhand's Chamoli. The quake, which logged a magnitude of 4.9 on the Richter scale, hit at 10:23 pm, the NCS added. Earlier on Tuesday, an earthquake of magnitude 4.5 struck Assam's Nagaon district, NCS said. The earthquake occurred at 4:23:47 am IST at a depth of 33 kilometres, the NCS said in a post on X.

India voices grave concern over Black Sea, Hormuz attacks

ASHOKE RAJ New Delhi

India has expressed grave concern over attacks on commercial vessels in the Black Sea and the Strait of Hormuz, after two foreign seafarers were killed and several crew members, including Indian nationals, were injured.

The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) condemned the attack on the MV Royad Mammadov in the Black Sea, where two foreign crew members lost their lives.

Several other members of the crew were injured in the incident, including Indian nationals. The injured seafarers were rescued by Romanian authorities and are undergoing medical treatment, the MEA said.

The ministry confirmed that the three Indian nationals on the vessel's crew are safe. It also thanked Romanian authorities for their prompt assistance following the attack.

India said attacks on commercial shipping and seafarers were a serious threat to international trade and the welfare of people worldwide.

CONTINUED ON >> P4



AIR MARSHAL ASHUTOSH DIXIT TO BE NEXT IAF CHIEF

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE New Delhi

Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit is the next IAF chief and will take charge after the incumbent Chief of Air Staff, Amar Preet Singh, retires on October 31. Air Marshal Dixit is presently Vice Chief.

Announcing this on Tuesday, the Defence Ministry said the Government has appointed Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit as the 29th Chief of the Air Staff, in the rank



of Air Chief Marshal, with effect from the afternoon of October 31. The current Chief of the Air Staff, Air Chief Marshal Amar Preet Singh, will superannuate on October 31, 2026.

Born on December 9, 1966, Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit was commissioned into the fighter stream of the Indian Air Force on December 6, 1986. Prior to assuming charge as the Vice Chief of the Air Staff, Air Marshal Dixit served as Chief of Integrated Defence Staff to the Chairman, Chiefs of Staff Committee (CISC) at Headquarters Integrated Defence Staff (HQ IDS) and as Air Officer Commanding-in-Chief, Central Air Command.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

Hotel horror: 3 held over alleged abduction bid in Delhi

ABHINAV KUMAR JHA New Delhi

Three men have been arrested for allegedly trying to force a woman from Nagaland into their Mercedes car outside a five-star hotel in New Delhi's Chanakyapuri area, and assaulting her friends with hockey sticks and iron rods when they intervened, police said on Tuesday. The incident occurred around 3:30 am on Sunday in the hotel's parking area.

According to the complaint, the woman had gone to the hotel with a friend. As the two were returning from the washroom, the three accused, travelling in a white Mercedes, allegedly approached and tried to stop the woman and pull her into their vehicle.

Her friends, identified as Ayush, Udbhav and Samarth, intervened after noticing what police described as the accused's objectionable conduct. The accused allegedly attacked the three



Representational image iStock

men with hockey sticks and iron rods. Ayush sustained injuries to his teeth, while Udbhav and Samarth were also beaten, police said.

Police reached the spot soon after, by which time the accused had fled in their car. The complainant had noted down the vehicle's registration number, which helped investigators trace the three men, identified as Divyanshu, Gaurav and Mohit.

Police registered a case against the accused at Chanakyapuri police station. The woman was taken to Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital for a medical examination, and police said the case was registered based on her complaint and the medical report.

Investigators are examining CCTV footage from the hotel and assessing medical reports of those injured to establish the sequence of events and the extent of injuries. During questioning, the accused denied some of the allegations, police said, and investigators are weighing the available evidence, including CCTV footage, medical findings, and statements from those involved, before deciding on further action.

CONTINUED ON >> P4



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BJP hits back at Rahul's protest

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi


Senior BJP leader Ravi Shankar Prasad

Hitting back at the INDIA bloc protest led by Congress leader Rahul Gandhi, the BJP on Tuesday accused the Opposition of fomenting anarchy and said the marchers are "venting their frustration" over their electoral defeats by levelling baseless allegations against the constitutional bodies to malign their image. The BJP said the Congress is relaunching Rahul Gandhi.

Senior BJP leader Ravi Shankar Prasad slammed Rahul Gandhi, saying he is sitting in one of Delhi's most sensitive areas and fomenting anarchy. He said that the bottom line is very clear — Rahul Gandhi, his party president, and others are demanding a return to ballot papers and this implies that since they cannot win elections using honest technology, they want to win through booth capturing. Prasad added that they want to prevent Dalits and the poor in villages from voting, perhaps by throwing ink into ballot boxes and then securing a victory. This has been their strategy for years, he said.

"We condemn this. You, along with several other parties, approached the Supreme Court. In its verdict on May 26, the Supreme Court explained in detail that the SIR (Special Intensive Revision) process is legally valid. Action was taken accordingly. Your own Home Minister in Kerala admitted that it was because of the SIR process that you were able to defeat the CPM. You lost in Bengal, winning only two seats. You lost in Bihar, winning only two seats. You lost in Haryana, Maharashtra, and Delhi. So, what exactly do you want? You are disrespecting the public mandate. You are asking for the cancellation of elections where the people have voted for a winner. Rahul Gandhi does not respect any institution, be it the Supreme Court, the Election Commission, the Army, or any other institution...Should the dead be allowed to vote?... I strongly condemn this entire conduct of Rahul Gandhi. He seeks anarchy," he said.

Union minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan said that through this march, they are "venting their frustration" over their electoral defeats by levelling baseless allegations against the constitutional bodies to malign their image. "Friends in the opposition, the very system you are questioning is the one under which you won in Kerala. Was that victory illegitimate? You won in Karnataka. Was that victory illegitimate? You won in Himachal. Was that victory illegitimate? Opposition Governments were formed in Punjab and Jharkhand; were those victories illegitimate?" the senior BJP leader asked.

Speaking to reporters, Chouhan said accepting defeat is the fundamental spirit of democracy, and asked the Congress and its allies to "stop insulting democracy and maligning" democratic institutions. "If you question constitutional institutions, you will sin by plunging the country into the fires of anarchy. Do not sin plunging the nation into unrest and anarchy. The country and its people will never forgive you," he added. Referring to the Special Intensive Revision, Chouhan underlined that a clean voter list is essential for a "pristine" democracy and asked the opposition parties why the electoral rolls should not be cleansed.

BJP national spokesperson Sudhanshu Trivedi disputed Congress' claim that 13 crore voters had been deleted during the nationwide Special Intensive Revision (SIR), saying the figure cited by the Opposition referred to names removed from the draft electoral rolls and not final deletions. Citing Election Commission data, Trivedi said 2.8 crore people were dead, 6.3 crore had shifted, 1 crore were duplicate entries, and around 3 crore were not traceable. Taking a jibe at the Congress, Trivedi accused the party of seeking to shield fake voters. "I would like to ask Congress clearly. Who do they want to benefit by giving voting rights to the absent, shifted, dead and duplicate voters without any investigation? Does the Congress want to benefit someone by doing this?" the veteran BJP leader said.

West Bengal to be renamed Paschim Banga

SAUGAR SENGUPTA
Kolkata


West Bengal BJP president Samik Bhattacharya

In an apparent bid to end the decades-old debate over renaming the State, the West Bengal Government has finally decided to permanently rename and "lock" the name of West Bengal as Paschim Banga.

"Most probably," a decision would soon be taken on the issue, State BJP president Samik Bhattacharya said, adding, "the Government in all likelihood will table a bill to this effect in the coming Assembly session."

The name Paschim Banga would be preferred over other suggested names like Banga, Bangal, Bengal, Banga Bhoomi, Banga Pradesh etc. to maintain a connection to the history of the State's formation post Independence.

"This is a correct decision as the eastern part of the undivided Bengal has been taken away based on religion to form a separate country, firstly East Pakistan and then Bangladesh... So we must preserve the history of this part of the province that will tell the history of the biggest partition and migration of population in the history of humanity along with the woes and plight of the common person... Loss of their place of birth, property, life and everything... Crores of them, said another BJP leader and an MLA requesting anonymity.

The Left Front Government also raised the issue in 1999, initially passing a resolution for West Banga or Paschim Banga but eventually settling on the name Bangla after a public debate about reflecting a negative linguistic identity.

Subsequently, the Mamata Banerjee Government also proposed a name change, suggesting Paschim Bangal initially but settling for the names Bangla in Bengali, Bango in Hindi, and Bengal in English. Then Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee argued that the name West Bengal put the State at an alphabetical disadvantage during administrative meetings in Delhi, when the State's turn to speak came at the end. However, the then Union Government rejected the idea of three names.

This time round, "nothing of that sort will happen, and the name is almost finalised," said another BJP MLA, adding, "there has been a conscious effort to force Bengalis to forget their past... This name will bring back historical continuity."

INDIA bloc march: ECI says no political party requested a meeting till 4 pm

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Hours after the INDIA bloc MPs marched to the Election Commission of India (ECI) and staged a day-long protest, the poll panel on Tuesday evening said no political party had sought an appointment through its authorised representatives for a meeting with it until 4 pm.

The Commission said the Delhi Police later informed it that a delegation of MPs led by Leader of the Opposition in Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi wished to meet the poll panel and submit a memorandum.

The Commission said it learnt through the media that during the march of certain political parties towards the commission headquarters, some MPs wanted to meet the poll panel along with their delegation.

"Till 4 pm today, no political party, through its representatives, had sought an appointment for a meeting with the Election Commission," it said in a statement. Around 4 pm, the Commission received information from Delhi Police that a delegation of MPs led by Gandhi wanted to meet it and submit a memorandum.

The ECI said it had laid down a procedure for meetings with political parties in 2025, under which a delegation of a political party or a joint delegation of several parties seeks an appointment through its duly authorised representative. "The meeting is thereafter held at a time mutually agreed upon by both sides," the poll panel said.

When the Commission was considering the proposal for a meeting with the MPs, it was informed by the Delhi Police that the delegation comprised 240 parliamentarians and that the proposed venue was the Parliament House Annexe.

"The Election Commission considered this request unusual and therefore, it could not be accepted, as, in accordance with ECI protocol, such meetings are held only on the premises of the Election Commission of India," it said.

The Commission said it proposed sending its seniormost officer on duty to the meeting venue to receive the memorandum, which itself would have been an unprecedented step, but the MPs also declined the offer.

The Commission said it respected parliamentary and democratic processes as well as its own protocols and conventions, which are of utmost importance.

"Any political party may, at any time, request a meeting with the Election Commission; and the Commission, keeping in view the suitability of time, schedules a date and time for the meeting. This is a regular practice," it said.

High drama unfolded during the INDIA bloc's protest march from Parliament Street to the Election Commission headquarters earlier in the day, as Rahul Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, along with others, entered the Akashvani Bhawan premises in a bid to reach the poll body's office. Rahul Gandhi occupied the centre stage of the opposition's street protest, forcing a total lockdown of Parliament Street.

West Bengal bypolls: CM predicts comfortable victory

SAUGAR SENGUPTA
Kolkata


West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari

West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari presaged a record-breaking victory in the two Assembly seats of Nandigram and Rejinagar, in byelections held on Tuesday amid stray incidents and reporting demands from the Opposition Congress and the Left.

"The elections were peacefully conducted," Adhikari said, predicting a comfortable win from both the seats, particularly in Nandigram, which he said the BJP would win by a "record-breaking margin." Counting would take place on October 9.

"The voting has taken place peacefully, and people have taken part in it actively... I am sure the BJP will win comfortably... Particularly in Nandigram it will win by a record margin as the people have reposed faith in Prime Minister Narendra Modi's good work," Adhikari reiterated.

Repolling to the Nandigram seat was necessitated after sitting MLA Adhikari left the seat, preferring to retain the Bhawanipore seat in Kolkata, where he defeated former Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee in the April-May Assembly elections.

The two constituencies recorded a high polling rate, with Rejinagar at 78.42 per cent and Nandigram at about 79.39 per cent till 5 pm. The vote percentage was likely to go up a few notches further, as people were still standing in queues, sources said. "That the election was peaceful is proved by the high percentage of polling, as generally in Bengal about 60-65 per cent of people take part in by-elections," said BJP leader and MLA Sajal Ghosh.

The Congress, Left and the Trinamool Congress, however, rejected claims of peaceful polling, demanding repolling in both the seats.

While former Congress MP Adhir Chowdhury condemned the process as "violence in silence with the help of police," State Congress president Subhankar Sarkar demanded a re-poll, saying there was no change in the election pattern from what it was during the TMC regime.

"Our Rejinagar candidate is sitting in a dharna at the Rejinagar police station... By 3 pm there were complaints of booth capturing in at least 230 booths... the BJP goons beat our agents away," Sarkar said. Adhir Chowdhury said that the police were used to chase away the voters in booths after booths, whereas the BJP goons drove away the polling agents before they jointly rigged polls.

Sitting MLA from Rejinagar, Humayun Kabir, who earlier surrendered the seat necessitating a re-poll, also complained of "massive booth capturing" by the policemen, even threatening a counterattack, following which the police detained him. The CPI(M) candidate from Rejinagar also demanded a re-poll.

FROM PAGE - 3

Day of detention ends with Rahul, Priyanka...

Until just before sunset, he remained holed up inside the AIR compound in a defiant standoff with the police, who largely remained passively resolute in preventing the protesters from reaching the Election Commission office.

The march from Parliament's Makar Dwar had barely covered the short distance to Niti Aayog's office on Parliament Street when the road ahead disappeared behind a wall of multi-layer steel barricades. Police personnel stood packed behind them, and the column of MPs walking toward Nirvachan Sadan, the Election Commission's headquarters, stopped.

Rahul Gandhi was at the front. Within minutes, he had climbed onto the barricade itself, one of the metal structures lined end to end across the road, and stood on top of it waving the Tricolour above the heads of the crowd below. TMC's Abhishek Banerjee climbed up alongside him.

When the march could go no further forward, it sat down instead in front of Akashwani Bhawan. Rahul Gandhi, Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, SP's Akhilesh Yadav and a cluster of MPs lowered themselves onto the road surface in front of Niti Aayog. He began a dharna, cross-legged on the tarmac where, on an ordinary Tuesday, only traffic would move.

Priyanka Gandhi Vadra was taken to a waiting detention bus shortly after the sit-in began around 12.15 pm, one of several buses parked along the cordon for this purpose. She did not stay inside it for long and alighted the bus.

With the direct route to Nirvachan Sadan sealed, Rahul Gandhi, Priyanka Gandhi Vadra and a group of MPs, including Mahua Moitra and Abhishek Banerjee, turned toward the Akashvani Bhawan entrance and pushed against its gates.

Around 12.45 pm, party general secretary KC Venugopal and Rajya Sabha MP Pawan Khera reached the gate and sought entry. Deputy Commissioner of Police, New Delhi, Sachin Sharma arrived at the spot and began talks with the leaders, who eventually entered the premises.

Congress MPs Praniti Shinde, Deepender Hooda, and Charanjit Singh Channi, along with Seva Dal chief Srinivas BV, were also present. Gandhi's staff members Alankar Sawai and Srivatsa were inside as well.

Several MPs, including Brittas, returned to the protest site after being released from detention. Leaders who had been taken away in buses were back as the gathering continued into the afternoon. In the afternoon, mats were laid out under the tree, and the leaders sat there. While Rahul Gandhi remained mostly seated, Priyanka Gandhi spoke with the police.

Deputy Commissioner of Police Sachin Sharma arrived at the spot with a large contingent of personnel, moving in to clear the compound of the protesting MPs. In the operation that followed, Rahul Gandhi was seen being dragged by police personnel as officers began removing those still sitting on the Akashvani Bhawan grounds.

Between waiting and sloganeering, the protest acquired an oddly domestic rhythm. The leaders snacked on rolls from the city's well-known Khan Chacha, and when they needed a drink to wash it down, Rahul Gandhi reached not for a chilled can of an energy drink but for a bright red bottle of Sting.

Slogans rose and fell along the route and at the sit-in: "BJP hai, CEC hai," "Vote chor, gaddi chhod," and "Democracy not for sale," chanted in bursts as the crowd pressed and receded against the barricade line.

Delhi Police face sustained protest...

As a result, disruptions like blocked roads or delayed medical help feel more serious, and authorities have less time to respond.

The latest protests began on October 2, when Opposition parties gathered to challenge ECI decisions. Protesters said they were standing up for fair elections, but the Commission and Government denied any bias. On Tuesday, smaller groups continued the protests, taking turns in approved areas. Police kept barriers in place, checked entry points, and made sure emergency lanes stayed open. They said the day went smoothly but needed a lot of staff, with many officers working long hours and backup teams nearby. When asked about the new tactics being employed by those behind the protest, a senior Delhi Police officer said the biggest challenge is not any single protest, but the lack of breaks between them. For example, the protests at Jantar Mantar in June needed repeated barricades, talks with organisers, and traffic changes around Connaught Place.

Police had only partly reduced their presence when new protests started in October. Each event needs planning, crowd estimates, equipment setup, and coordination with traffic police, city officials, and hospitals. Often, when one protest ends, and another is set for the next day, the same police teams are sent to a new spot with little rest.

"Protests are allowed at approved sites as long as the rules on time, route, and number of people are followed," the official said.

Any march intended to go towards Parliament, the Election Commission, or other restricted areas must obtain prior permission, and the police will halt any unauthorised movement at the outer barriers. The police say they support legal protests and will intervene if rules are violated, for example by crossing barricades or blocking emergency routes, the official added.

Opposition leaders claim the rules are not applied fairly and that the new procedures make protests harder to hold. This has now become a commonplace element of everyday politics.

The effect on the ground is obvious. Near protest sites, some metro station exits are controlled or temporarily closed. Bus routes are altered, which causes delays for ordinary commuters. For a while, shops along protest routes have fewer customers. As for the police, their duties involve working extra hours, having leave cancelled, and repeatedly moving barricades and vehicles.

Women officers and rapid-response units take shifts at key sites, and medical and water supplies are arranged at larger protests. Although the Delhi Police have issued additional traffic advisories, route maps, and brief updates on detentions, these frequently fail to keep pace with the rapid dissemination of partisan videos. There is still ongoing debate over whether the police are too strict in their treatment of protests or not doing enough to maintain order.

Further demonstrations concerning the ECI are scheduled for the coming days, with various state groups sending their own delegations. Authorities have already issued traffic warnings, and they are still in communication with groups seeking permission to protest.

Officials say their primary aim is to keep protests within approved areas, ensure residents and essential services are not obstructed, and prevent the situation from getting out of control. Whether this succeeds will depend on how many people turn up, whether they stick to the planned routes, and how quickly the authorities can respond to problems.

Delhi has long witnessed political protests, but what stands out now is how close these events are, from those in June to those taking place now and those due in the coming days.

India voices grave concern over Black...

"The targeting of traffic in international waterways is severely undermining global commerce and the welfare of people across the world," the MEA said, reiterating India's support for dialogue and diplomacy to resolve ongoing conflicts.

The ministry also highlighted a new international initiative launched by India and Liberia during the United Nations General Assembly in September 2026. The two countries launched a 25-nation Group of Friends on Safety and Security of Shipping and Seafarers to strengthen international efforts to protect merchant crews and commercial vessels from targeted attacks.

Meanwhile, the MEA condemned another attack involving the Panama-flagged commercial vessel MT on peace off the coast of Oman while it was transiting the Strait of Hormuz.

The vessel was carrying 19 crew members, including 17 Indian nationals, when a projectile struck it. According to the MEA, 12 crew members were injured, of whom 11 were Indian nationals.

The injured crew members were evacuated with assistance from Omani authorities and taken to Khasab, Oman, for medical treatment. India expressed its appreciation to Oman for assisting. The MEA said the repeated attacks on shipping in the region remained a matter of deep concern and called for an immediate halt to such incidents. India urged that attacks targeting commercial vessels, seafarers and civilian infrastructure must end. In contrast, the safe movement of ships and commercial activity through international waterways should be restored at the earliest.

The latest developments come amid heightened security concerns across major maritime routes, including the Strait of Hormuz, the Red Sea and the Black Sea.

Separately, the United Kingdom Maritime Trade Operations (UKMTO) reported that a commercial tanker travelling through the Strait of Hormuz was forced to turn back after allegedly being hailed and threatened by Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC).

The incident took place on Monday at around 08:27 UTC, approximately 11 nautical miles north of Khasab, Oman. According to the UKMTO advisory, the vessel was warned that it could be targeted if it failed to comply with instructions to turn back. The master subsequently confirmed that the crew complied and altered the vessel's course. The incidents have renewed concerns over the safety of international shipping and seafarers as commercial vessels continue to navigate increasingly volatile maritime corridors.

Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit to be next IAF chief

The Air Marshal is an alumnus of the National Defence Academy, Defence Staff Service College (Bangladesh) and National Defence College. He has more than 3,500 hours of extensive flying experience on various aircraft, including, to name a few, Mirage-2000, variants of MiG, Kiran, Jaguar, IL-78, HAWK and Tejas. He is an experimental test pilot and a qualified flying instructor. During his service career spanning approximately four decades, he has been actively involved in numerous operations and exercises, including Op Safed Sagar, Op Rakshak and Op Sindoor.

During his illustrious career, the Air Marshal has held several significant field and staff appointments. He commanded a front-line fighter air base in the Western Sector and a premier fighter training base in the Southern Sector. The operational capability of the Indian Air Force has improved with the contribution of the Air Officer in various capacities. He was awarded the Vayu Sena Medal in 2006, the Vishisht Seva Medal in 2011, the Ati Vishisht Seva Medal in 2023, and the Param Vishisht Seva Medal in 2026 in recognition of his exemplary and distinguished service.

Hotel horror: 3 held over alleged abduction bid...

Police have not yet disclosed the specific sections under which the accused have been charged, nor the current custodial status of the three men beyond confirming their arrest.

The case has drawn attention because the complainant is a woman from India's northeast. This community has repeatedly reported incidents of harassment and racial profiling while living or visiting Delhi. Civil society groups and northeastern students' bodies in the capital have in the past flagged a pattern of such complaints. However, police in this case have not cited any racial motive and have confined their account to an alleged attempt at forced abduction followed by an assault on bystanders who intervened.

Chanakyapuri, home to several five-star hotels and diplomatic missions, falls under one of Delhi's more heavily policed districts, and the presence of CCTV coverage at the hotel is expected to be central to investigators' efforts to corroborate the complainant's account against the accused's denials.

The case remains under investigation, with police saying further legal action will depend on the findings from the CCTV review, medical assessments and recorded statements of the complainant, her friends and the accused.

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY | OCTOBER 7, 2026

World Bank raises India's FY27 GDP growth forecast to 7.1%

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

The World Bank on Tuesday praised India's robust economic growth despite global turmoil, raising the country's GDP forecast for the current fiscal year to 7.1 per cent, up 0.5 percentage points from its April projections, supported by strong domestic demand and exports.

India remains one of the fastest-growing major economies in the world and a key contributor to global growth, the multilateral organisation said in its latest India Development Update.

"We have upgraded our FY27 growth forecast to 7.1 per cent from 6.6 per cent in April, as growth has held up better than expected despite trade and geopolitical uncertainties," it said.

India's growth accelerated to 7.8 per cent in FY26 from 7.2 per cent in FY25, driven by strong investment and solid private consumption, as favourable policy and credit environment outweighed trade tensions.

The medium-term prospects are strong, the World Bank said, but it also cautioned that external risks are elevated, including downside risks related to global oil prices, El Niño, and stock market corrections that could cause capital flow volatility.

It noted that rural consumption initially outpaced urban demand supported by strong agricultural performance, while urban consumption strengthened later in the year following income-tax relief and GST cuts.

The momentum has carried into FY27, with GDP growing 7.8 per cent in Q1, above expectations, before moderating in subsequent quarters, it said.



Private consumption is expected to remain the main driver of growth. However, a rainfall deficit through August is likely to weigh modestly on rural demand, while subdued Government consumption will stay muted, it said.

The investment outlook is broadly unchanged, with heightened global uncertainty weighing on private investment as front-loading fades, partly offset by supportive financial and policy conditions, including stronger public investment, it said.

India's exports have performed better than expected and are likely to provide the main upside to the FY27 growth outlook relative to the April forecasts, it said.

On the supply side, it said, the industry is now forecast to perform better than initially expected, offsetting a weaker agricultural outlook.

Since April, industrial activity has exceeded expectations despite global headwinds. This partially reflects the stronger-than-expected front-loading earlier in the year, with infrastructure and construction goods growth accelerating to 7.2 per cent in Q1 from 6.1 per cent last year, as well as the higher summer utility demand, which drove the electricity sector to expand by 9.3 per cent in Q1 compared to a 1.5 per cent contraction last year.

Although above-average rainfall since July narrowed the monsoon deficit, the overall rainfall shortage during the southwest monsoon has weakened agricultural prospects, it said.

The World Bank also said the services sector growth remained elevated despite a slowdown from the high base in FY26.

Assuming the energy supply chain returns to pre-conflict (West Asia conflict) conditions in early 2027, it said growth is projected to accelerate to 7.2 per cent in FY28 and ease to 7 per cent in FY29, in line with the economy's medium-term potential.

The Government's recent reform programmes, including GST rationalisation, trade and FDI liberalisation, labour-market reforms and measures to improve access to finance for MSMEs are expected to gain momentum over the medium term, supporting growth, it said.

Last month, the Asian Development Bank (ADB), the OECD, and other global agencies like S&P and Fitch raised India's FY27 GDP growth projection to around 7 per cent, boosted by robust June quarter economic activity and resilient domestic demand despite the West Asia conflict.

Paris-based Organisation for Economic Cooperation and Development (OECD) upped GDP growth forecast by 80 basis points to 7.1 per cent for FY27.

ADB, while raising the growth forecast to 7 per cent, from 6.6 per cent estimated in July, said the Indian economy has benefited from lower-than-expected supply disruptions and sustained capital inflows, which helped cushion the impact of the conflict in West Asia.

ED summons Punjab CM's brother-in-law over bribery probe

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
New Delhi/Chandigarh



The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has summoned Amardeep Singh Grewal, brother-in-law of Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann and a Punjabi film industry professional, for questioning over bribery allegations involving the Chief Minister's wife, Dr Gurpreet Kaur Mann, agency sources said.

According to a source familiar with the developments, the ED initially summoned Grewal to appear on October 7. However, after an appeal, the agency has now asked him to appear at its Delhi office on October 9.

Grewal is connected to M/S East Sunshine Production Pvt Ltd and has worked on Punjabi films such as *Maujaan Hi Maujaan* (2023) and *Snowman* (2022). Investigators say these films have links to overseas production and releases.

Officials involved in the investigation said the summons is meant to examine Grewal's role in the transactions under review and any movement of funds that could fall under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act.

The allegations date back to early September, when Shiromani Akali Dal leader Bikram Singh Majithia released what he said were call recordings between Grewal and Simranjit Singh Hundal, who was reportedly representing Gurvinder Singh, also known as Guri Chahal, a man facing several rape charges. In these recordings, Grewal is accused of asking for several crore rupees, with opposition parties claiming the amount could be as high as ₹5 crore, in exchange for resolving the cases. He is also alleged to have named senior police officers who would help him. Majithia also shared a photo and CCTV footage that he said showed Dr Gurpreet Kaur Mann at Rhapsody Bar and Kitchen on May 20, claiming the meeting was to finalise the deal.

The National Human Rights Commission responded to a complaint that included a public allegation by retired Punjab and Haryana High Court judge Justice Ranjit Singh. In August, the Commission asked the Punjab Chief Secretary and the Director General of Police to investigate and provide a report. Earlier, Hundal approached the High Court, claiming Grewal was demanding crores of rupees to drop the cases against Chahal by using his connection to the Chief Minister's wife. In a related case, the father's petition was closed in July, and the investigation was assigned to a Special Director General of Police.

Dr Gurpreet Kaur Mann has denied the accusation. She sent a legal notice to Justice Ranjit Singh, calling the claim false, baseless, and defamatory, and asked for proof. The Aam Aadmi Party said the recordings were staged and politically motivated. Party spokespersons pointed to photos they say show Grewal and Chahal with BJP and Shiromani Akali Dal leaders, and questioned the timing of the campaign as elections approach.

Bharatiya Janata Party spokesperson Pradeep Bhandari accused Mann, his wife, and AAP national convenor Arvind Kejriwal of running an extortion 'syndicate' through intermediaries to settle rape cases. SAD MP Harsimrat Kaur Badal met with the National Commission for Women chairperson. He asked for an FIR against the Chief Minister's wife, a CBI investigation, and Mann's resignation on moral grounds. Sukhbir Singh Badal later mentioned village posters with a QR code that played the disputed audio when scanned.

The summons came a day after the Punjab and Haryana High Court directed the CBI to register a case based on separate Enforcement Directorate reports about a cash-for-transfers and favours network linked to the Chief Minister's Office, focusing on OSD Rajbir Singh Ghuman and private intermediaries. The State Government has appealed to the Supreme Court against this order. Officials said the Grewal summons is related to the family bribery allegations, not the transfer-posting case, but both investigations are happening in the same political context.

Grewal has not made a public statement about the summons. ED officials would not confirm the date of his appearance or whether they have already recorded his statement under the money-laundering law. Meanwhile, the ruling party argued the case rests only on unverified audio and would not hold up to independent review.

CBI books Punjab CM's OSD Ghuman, raids 8 locations

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
New Delhi/Chandigarh



Representative image

The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) on Tuesday booked Rajbir Singh Ghuman, Officer on Special Duty (OSD) to Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann, and five others, and then searched eight premises linked to them across Punjab and Chandigarh.

The FIR followed an order of the Punjab and Haryana High Court and a report from the Enforcement Directorate. The allegations concern influence over postings, files and licences around the CM's office.

The CBI said the case involves manipulating transfers and postings, including those of IAS and IPS officers. It also covers interference in departmental proceedings, promotions, approvals, tenders, licensing, land-use changes, property disputes, and revenue matters. The agency also alleges that some public servants shared drafts of orders and policies with private individuals before making them official.

The FIR lists Ghuman, Nitin Gohal, Jitin Gohal (also known as Raja), Romi Raja Mahajan, Bir Devinder, and RS Nagra, as well as some unnamed public servants and private individuals. According to the agency, two of these six are public servants, while the others are described as middlemen and associates.

CBI teams searched locations in Chandigarh, Mohali, Gurdaspur, Ludhiana, Patiala, Sangrur, and Jalandhar. Officers took laptops, mobile phones, and documents, and said they are reviewing the evidence. Reports said teams were seen at the Chief Minister's camp office in Sector 2, Chandigarh, at Ghuman's house in Gharachon village in Sangrur, and at a Phase 11 home in Mohali linked to a close relative. The CBI said the investigation is still ongoing.

The High Court issued the order on Monday, with Chief Justice Ashwani Kumar Mishra and Justice Rohit Kapoor, on a public interest petition filed by advocate Nikhil Saraf. The ED wrote to the Punjab Director General of Police in July and August, asking for an FIR. The material described Nitin Gohal as an intermediary between people seeking Government favours and Ghuman, and referred to transfers and access to confidential documents.

The court noted that the police started a preliminary inquiry and called in some people but did not involve Ghuman or seek his response. The judges said they were not satisfied with how the case was handled. They found that the ED's material showed possible offences by someone in a high public office, and ordered the CBI to register a case, investigate, and report within two months. The state was told to help with the investigation.

Before the searches were finished, the Punjab Government approached the Supreme Court. A special leave petition challenging the High Court order was filed early Tuesday and was still pending while teams continued their searches.

Opposition leaders, including Shiromani Akali Dal president Sukhbir Singh Badal, called it a cash-for-postings case and questioned why the State police had not filed an FIR based on the ED's letters. Meanwhile, the Chief Minister's camp said the action was politically motivated.

J&K Govt approves land for BSNL towers in remote areas

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Jammu

The Jammu and Kashmir Government, led by Chief Minister Omar Abdullah, on Tuesday approved land for mobile tower installations in underserved areas across the Union Territory to strengthen high-speed telecom connectivity in remote and border villages.

Under the initiative, the Government has approved land for installing BSNL mobile towers in underserved areas of Uri, Tangmarg, Karnah, Kalakote, Kralpora, Basantgarh, Khour, Latti Marothi, Banihal, Pogal Paristan, Ramsoo and Qila Darhal under the Universal Service Obligation Fund (USOF).

Chief Minister Omar Abdullah said the initiative would help extend reliable connectivity to remote and border communities and ensure that geographical location does not become a barrier to access to digital services and opportunities.

The USOF is developing the infrastructure to expand 4G network coverage and achieve telecom saturation in areas that remain underserved.



Ex-Leh DC removed as Looms of Ladakh chief

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Jammu


Ex-Deputy Commissioner of Leh Prasanna Ramaswamy

A former Deputy Commissioner of Leh, Prasanna Ramaswamy, has been removed as the Chairman of the Looms of Ladakh Women Cooperative Ltd governing body.

The current Deputy Commissioner, Leh, will now take charge as Chairman, in accordance with the Articles of Association of the Cooperative.

The Looms of Ladakh Women Cooperative, registered in 2017, has faced serious charges of financial misconduct and conflict of interest.

Accordingly, the matter was taken up by the UT Administration with the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) for examination and for appropriate action in view of the apparent conflict-of-interest issues involving the officer.

Prasanna Ramaswamy, a 2010-batch IAS officer, served as the Registrar of Cooperative Societies (RCS) and Deputy Commissioner, Leh, during 2015-2017. The registration documents record Ramaswamy and his spouse, Abhilasha Bahuguna, as co-founder members of the Society.

According to records examined by the UT Administration, the Looms of Ladakh Women Cooperative has also received significant financial support for activities relating to Pashmina and wool development.

According to its audited financial statements, the Cooperative reported receiving ₹50.76 lakh in grants, donations and contributions during FY 2022-23, ₹71.34 lakh during FY 2023-24, and ₹44.99 lakh during FY 2024-25. Taken together, these reported receipts amount to approximately ₹1.67 crore over the three financial years. Separately, documentary records cited by NABARD establish that ₹107.50 lakh (₹1.075 crore) was sanctioned as grant assistance to the Cooperative under a project for "Strengthening and Broadbasing Pashmina and Wool Value Chain in Leh."

The project included strengthening production and value-chain activities and envisaged the establishment of a 40,000 sq. ft. Work Studio and Training Centre at Chushul, Leh.

Navi Mumbai airport shift likely delayed by a few weeks

ASHOKE RAJ ■ New Delhi

The Ministry of Civil Aviation has asked domestic airlines and the airport operator to submit a firm transition plan for shifting operations from Mumbai's Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport (CSMIA) to Navi Mumbai International Airport (NMIA), sources said.

The ministry has also proposed delaying the transition by a few weeks as stakeholders work to finalise operational arrangements for shifting up to 5 million international passengers annually from Mumbai airport to NMIA.

A consultation meeting between the Secretary, Ministry of Civil Aviation, airlines and the airport operator is scheduled for October 13 to firm up the transition plan. Another meeting is expected to be held by October 20 to discuss and finalise the roadmap.

The discussions are part of the phased redevelopment of Terminal 1 at CSMIA and the planned transition of airline operations to NMIA.

At the meeting, domestic airlines including IndiGo, Air India and Akasa said they had been in discussions with the airport operator on the proposed transition for the past 18 months.



Representatives of Adani Airport Holdings Ltd (AAHL), Airports Authority of India (AAI), the Federation of Indian Airlines (FIA) and various domestic airlines attended the meeting.

AAHL outlined its preparedness to handle up to 5 million international passengers annually at NMIA and highlighted the airport's supporting infrastructure and passenger facilities, including connectivity, in-flight catering, hotels and lounges.

During the nearly 90-minute meeting, AAHL leadership held detailed discussions with airline operators and addressed operational concerns and queries related to the proposed transition and redevelopment plan.

The discussions were constructive, with stakeholders reaffirming their commitment to a smooth, coordinated transition while maintaining passenger convenience and operational efficiency, sources said.

A decision on the User Development Fee (UDF) for NMIA is still pending with the Ministry of Civil Aviation.

The phased redevelopment of Terminal 1 at Mumbai airport is expected to increase its annual passenger-handling capacity from 15 million to 20 million passengers.

Mumbai Airport has decided to redevelop Terminal 1 to increase its annual passenger-handling capacity from 15 million to 20 million passengers, while upgrading infrastructure and improving passenger facilities. To support the phased redevelopment, some airline operations are proposed to shift to Navi Mumbai International Airport (NMIA).

West Asia crisis pushes up ATF costs, Govt considers price stabilisation fund

ASHOKE RAJ ■ New Delhi


Representative image

The Government is examining the possibility of bringing back a price stabilisation mechanism for Aviation Turbine Fuel (ATF) as rising jet fuel prices put increasing pressure on airlines.

Civil Aviation Minister K Rammohan Naidu said the Government is discussing with airlines and oil marketing companies (OMCs) the impact of higher ATF prices, particularly amid continuing geopolitical tensions in West Asia.

Speaking on the sidelines of a conference in New Delhi on Tuesday, Naidu said the surge in fuel prices linked to the West Asia situation has become a significant concern for the aviation sector.

ATF is one of the largest components of airline operating costs, accounting for roughly 40 per cent of total expenses. A sustained increase in fuel prices can therefore put considerable pressure on airline finances and ticket prices.

A senior Government official said authorities are considering whether to revive an ATF price stabilisation fund. Details of the proposal, including its structure and funding mechanism, were not immediately available.

The Government had earlier introduced a one-time support mechanism for the sector. In June, the Union Cabinet approved budgetary assistance of up to ₹10,000 crore for OMCs to help stabilise ATF prices and relieve domestic airlines. However, airlines showed little interest in using the facility, and the scheme has since lapsed.

The issue has gained renewed attention after InterGlobe Aviation (IndiGo) decided to increase fuel surcharges on domestic and international flights. The airline attributed the move to elevated and volatile ATF prices amid geopolitical developments in the West East.

IndiGo said the latest month-on-month increase in fuel prices had exceeded 14 per cent, pushing ATF costs to levels among the highest recorded over the past decade.

Airlines have also called for changes to the way jet fuel is priced in India. Last month, the Federation of Indian Airlines (FIA), which represents Air India, IndiGo and SpiceJet, urged the Civil Aviation Ministry to reconsider the existing pricing formula.

The industry body has argued that domestic ATF should be priced based on the actual cost of fuel, along with a reasonable margin, rather than being linked primarily to international benchmark prices.

According to the FIA, higher fuel expenses, combined with geopolitical disruptions and a weaker rupee, are putting substantial pressure on airline cash flows and the financial viability of carriers.

With fuel costs remaining volatile, the Government's discussions with airlines and OMCs could determine whether it introduces a revised stabilisation mechanism and how it structures any future support.

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY | OCTOBER 7, 2026

Editor's TAKE

India-Swiss ties need a fourth T: Tracking

Switzerland's President Guy Parmelin's second visit to India this year signals a relationship moving beyond traditional commerce

When a Swiss president makes his first state visit to India, his second trip here this year naturally means that the relationship between the two countries is growing. Guy Parmelin's three-day visit, which began on Monday, marks the first anniversary of the India-EFTA trade agreement, and Bern wants to see what a year of free trade has delivered. The agenda follows the "3Ts" framing of India's Ministry of External Affairs: trade, technology and talent.

Trade is anchored by the Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement (TEPA), in force since October 1, 2025. Its headline promise is $100 billion of investment from the four EFTA states over 15 years, $50 billion in the first 10, and one million direct jobs. Parmelin attends the second India-EFTA Prosperity Summit on Wednesday to take stock.

The two sides signed a Migration and Mobility Partnership offering multiple-entry visas of up to five years and renewable one-year student permits, alongside a young professionals' exchange agreement. A further memorandum covers electric vehicles, ropeways, tunnelling and the circular economy. Prime Minister Modi also spoke of new avenues in military exchanges and defence manufacturing, and of expanded nuclear energy cooperation, a widening of the scope of a relationship long defined by commerce.

The relationship is old and largely uncomplicated. Ties have been cordial since independence, helped by Indian non-alignment and Swiss neutrality. The leaders met in New Delhi in February, at the AI Impact Summit, and in Geneva in June. Switzerland hosts the next global AI summit in 2027, a move Delhi has welcomed.

The economic ledger, however, is lopsided. In 2024-25, India imported $21.8 billion of goods from Switzerland and exported $1.47 billion. Swiss direct investment totalled $10.87 billion between April 2000 and June 2025, and over 330 Swiss companies operate in India. Swiss capital is visible on the ground: a Zurich Airport subsidiary operates Noida International Airport, and Swiss technology helped build the Varanasi ropeway.

There has been friction too. Switzerland suspended the most-favoured-nation clause in its tax treaty with India from January 2025, after the Supreme Court's Nestlé ruling, a reminder that goodwill needs tax certainty to survive.

Investors will also read the $100 billion target for what it is: a figure that companies, not governments, must ultimately deliver. India's task is to make that easy, through predictable taxation, regulatory clarity and speed.

Parmelin called his visit a "stepping stone", and the phrase fits. The 3Ts need a fourth: tracking. A joint annual review of investment flows, jobs created and visas issued would turn a handsome promise into a measurable one. The next year will decide whether this partnership is remembered for its summits or for its factories, laboratories and jobs.

Am Yisrael Chai, Captain Smit

On 30-9, the world was rocked by the unbelievable scenes of courage, bravery and singular heroism of the pilot and passengers of flydubai FZ-1073 on 30 September 2026, as they staved off an attempt by an Omani co-pilot to crash the aircraft or, as some allege, perform a 9/11-type attack on Israel



SANJAY LAZAR



The bravery of Captain Smit Machchhar, as he was being hacked by his second-in-command, has passed into global aviation folklore that even seasoned pilots and aviation professionals may never be able to comprehend. To be brutally attacked and stabbed with the aircraft crash axe (the actual details are still sketchy), and then turn on the transponders to 7700 and again to 7500 to warn the external world, speaks of a clarity of mind and singular purpose by Captain Smit that is unthinkable. In moments of personal danger, where the only eventuality is a certain death, human beings draw on their reservoirs of courage to do what the captain did, and crawled to the cockpit door to unlock it, even as the first officer kept denying access to outside crew using the emergency code. Further actions of Tali and Nina Manes, warning the passengers of what was happening in the cockpit, the quick-fire response of Yaniv Hayoun, and the actions of the two reserve pilots, without a doubt, saved the lives of 174 passengers that day.

The flight radar data has shocked the world of aviation. How could a 737 descend that rapidly without breaking up or suffering major critical damage? The pressure exerted by the "almost freefall" was many Gs more than the aircraft could withstand. Yet we saw how it landed, battered and bruised. The apparent act of the Israeli plumber Yaniv Hayoun, of pulling the yoke back and stabilising the aircraft, is out of an adventure story, but we know it happened. People question, how come none of the passengers suffered the injuries that we saw in the Air India Phuket flight or last year's Singapore Airlines flight? Was the fact that they were all buckled in, entering sterile Israeli airspace, the reason? We may never know, but let's wait for the reports to emerge, or was the descent not as sharp as imagined?

Was this a false-flag operation? Only a naïve conspiracy theorist would believe that. This was a valiant rescue by a bunch of unlikely heroes. I have spoken to my Indian pilot friends who fly with flydubai, and they are as shaken up by this, and proud of Captain Smit, as all of us are. It is a rescue effort beyond all imagination, just in the same way the heroes of United Flight 93 on 9/11 fought back.

Is this kind of a rescue and recovery possible in normal circumstances? No, not at all. It's unthinkable. Even if it was simulated 100 times, it would fail 99/100 times, but it worked this one time and they are all alive to tell the tale. It tells of the courage and fortitude of brave human beings in dangerous circumstances.

Sometimes it takes many miracles to save the day. This was one such day. If even one of the people in this chain of events had not acted as they did, we would have mourned our dead today. So rather than question, let us celebrate them all.

The co-pilot assassin

Details have emerged that the co-pilot, Hammam Al-Hammami, was part Syrian and part Omani, and was asked to leave Oman Air due to questionable behaviour. There are indications emerging that he was radicalised, and some officials in the UAE are also being investigated. If he was removed from Oman Air for these reasons, then how did he find employment in flydubai? And that too, flying into Israel?

What went wrong?

As much as I admire and love Israel and its people, and shall always, they will be the first to stand up and analyse what exactly went wrong and single out the faults in their system that were exposed by this Omani co-pilot, that almost caused the biggest act of aviation terror since 9/11.

Prima facie, it appears to be a:

1. Failure of APIS to track the system intruder.
2. Apparent lack of pre-advance intelligence of such a threat.
3. Breach of bilateral ASAs post the Abraham Accords.
4. Failure of flydubai to have screened its pilots properly.

The US first created APIS in 1989, but it was never made mandatory until 9/11. Under APIS, all airlines forward detailed passenger and crew lists with passport numbers, visa numbers and details of travellers (crew and passengers) at least 24 hours in advance to be scrutinised by the Department of Homeland Security. Israel is one such nation that follows the API system, and the NCPIA hub tracks all incoming passengers and crew. So how did the Israeli NCPIA miss the warning signs of Captain Hammami? This will be investigated deep and hard, especially in light of his past record at Oman Air.

There was apparently no known advance intelligence of such a plot or chatter on the networks, despite Israel and the USA being at war with Iran. Guards seem to have been lowered post the Abraham Accords, and I have a sense that there will be a thorough re-evaluation of the system.

Post the Abraham Accords, the APIS stipulations are clear: crew belonging to any nation that refuses to recognise Israel, or that treats Israel as an enemy, are barred from flying into Israeli airspace, namely Oman, Syria and Iran. How did Hammami escape the dragnet despite having both Omani and Syrian connections?

The Future

Aviation changed inexorably post 9/11 and reinforced steel doors, cockpit and crew protocols came into being, and APIS became an advanced screening tool. In the early days post 9/11, I recall days and flights when pilots with Muslim names were being delayed clearance by Homeland Security or extensive security backgrounds were sought.

So what does 30-9 flydubai hold for us?

For one, we can expect detailed background checks of aviation personnel and pre-authorisation APIS to become stricter, maybe even a restrictive list of pre-qualified pilots to enter Israeli territory from Arab nations.

For the larger aviation world, a similar protocol would not be amiss, since we seem to have lowered our guard. I expect Shin Bet and Mossad and the NCPIA to have greater coordination with Arab, US and Indian intelligence networks and Homeland Security to screen crew and travellers. The threat is real, a 9/11 or a 30-9 can happen any time again.

The dreaded CCTV (closed-circuit cockpit cameras) may come into the larger global discussion once more to ensure that there is some modicum of protocols adhered to and a recording of what transpired.

I also believe that Israel will demand more flights bring in sky marshals, and security around flights departing for TLV will have heightened security.

The cockpit safety equipment (crash axe) is normally shielded and protected, so there will be a conversation about the use and need for it and how to secure it. Whilst airlines would love to reduce cockpit crew to one if they could, due to commercial considerations, in my view, there must now be a discussion of having an observer or a third occupant in the cockpit to safeguard the situation, especially when flying on sensitive routes.

The regulators and politicians around the world, especially India, must learn and accept that pilots are the reason that we land and take off safely each day around the world. We need to stop treating them like punching bags. India has the worst working conditions for pilots on earth, and yet it was an Indian pilot (who had escaped Indian aviation bureaucracy) who has made India and pilots, and indeed all aviation crew all over the world, intensely proud.

In the end, aviation is still the safest mode of travel on earth, and pilots are the most misunderstood professionals. India and Israel are two ancient civilisations bound by blood and brotherhood. Thank you, Captain Smit Machchhar, Tali and Nina Manes, Yaniv and the two unnamed relief pilots. You made us believe in miracles again. Am Yisrael Chai, Jai Hind.

The writer is an aviation expert, lawyer & author who writes on aviation, terrorism, International relations, leadership and law. He has spent 40 years in aviation and lost his entire family in the Air India Kanishka bombing in 1985

Daiv Vani

WISDOM FOR A MEANINGFUL LIFE

A Little Duty That Saves From Great Fear

Dharma is tested least in comfort and most in the last moments of our strength.

In September 2026, on a flight from Dubai to Tel Aviv, Captain Smit Machchhar was attacked in the cockpit by his own co-pilot with a knife and an emergency axe, in what investigators describe as an attempt to crash the plane. Stabbed in the head and hands, he could no longer fight or fly. Yet he found enough strength to unlock the cockpit door. Passengers rushed in, levelled the diving aircraft and restrained the attacker, while a doctor on board stopped the captain's bleeding. The plane landed in Saudi Arabia with 174 people aboard, and all of them survived.

The Bhagavad Gita says, "svalpam apy asya dharmasya trayate mahato bhayat": even a little of this dharma protects us from great fear (2.40). The captain did not save the flight alone. He did one small, essential thing at the very edge of his strength, and that opened the way for others to do the rest. Duty need not be grand to be decisive.

We often wait until we feel strong, resourced and certain before we act. The Gita asks only that we do what is ours to do, whatever our condition, and leave the outcome to a larger order.

Today, do the one small duty that is yours, even if you are tired, and trust that it may open a door for someone else. –DAIV

PIC TALK



A man carries freshly harvested water lilies in Nadia, West Bengal. The stems are a seasonal festive delicacy. PHOTO: PTI

Optimising life through spiritual practice



AJIT KUMAR BISHNOI

2ND OPINION



We are all different and, therefore, must personalise our spiritual practices and daily routine. Only then can these be sustained. Lord Krishna has given specific instructions in this regard. The Lord states, "Yoga of one whose eating and recreation are appropriate; of one who strives appropriately in activities; of one who sleeps and stays awake as required, becomes the cause of elimination of sufferings." (The Bhagavad-Gita, verse #6.17) Mark the last part. The elimination of sufferings must be the result, otherwise who will continue the exercise?

Going into the details of the quoted verse, Lord Krishna has instructed us to be appropriate in four parts of our daily routine. These are food, entertainment, work and sleep. Food must suit an individual. For example, an aged person must restrict oneself to what is nutritious, wholesome and easily digestible. The same goes for sleep; children need more sleep than old people. Entertainment must also be different age-wise. Younger people can have more of the physical types, like playing games, while older folks can have 'satsang' (good company), gentle walks and simple exercises.

Intelligent practitioners of 'yoga' (connection with God) balance efforts for maintenance and spiritual progress. In younger age, it is more learning and effort for maintenance, with occasional prayers for guidance and help when troubled. Later, it must be more for spiritual upliftment. This is when the instruction given in verse #9.22 becomes applicable, which is, "These people, who worship Me with undivided attention, meditating on Me, for those practitioners of yoga, I help in getting what one does not have and security of what one has." In older age, more spiritual practices are required, when maintenance duties become less.

Lord Krishna has, in the Gita, given many options for doing spiritual practices. One has to choose what suits them in order to be able to do them. Instructions given by the Lord will help in making choices, which is, "For a saintly person, desirous of making progress in yoga, action is known to be the means, but for one fixed in yoga, peace is known to be the only cause." (6.3) Do these practices conveniently in order not to lose peace of mind. The idea is to get help from God; our role in life can be limited only. God must become 'karta' (doer) in our life, and we His 'nimitta' (instrument). Then success is certain.

This is what I am doing. I engage my mind in God by chanting gently while looking at a photo of Lord Krishna, convinced that my Lord will accept my prayers (12.8). And God will guide me about what I must do and help where He only can help. In short, I must continue to do my minor part in life and God will take care of the major part to ensure success. The result: I am engaged appropriately by optimising my spiritual practices and also my daily routine. 'Theek chal raha hai' (Life is fruitful and beautiful).

The writer is a spiritual teacher and a columnist

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Makkah Pact fails first test

The article 'Pakistan's Yemen dilemma deepens' (6 Oct) proves beyond doubt that the Makkah Pact has failed its first test. Not only Pakistan, but Türkiye too, faltered in defending Saudi Arabia against Houthi attacks. The Makkah Pact was merely a reaction to the West Asian crisis, and its efficacy was doubtful from the outset.

Countries across West Asia, besieged by wars against each other, with the US acting as the fuel tank, are also facing civil strife. Hundreds of militias, such as the Houthis, operate across the region, while unified military commands remain fragile. The wealth of West Asian countries is depleting rapidly, and their leaderships are increasingly challenged within their own countries. In these circumstances, the Makkah Pact, its signatories and their commitments are bound to face serious challenges.

Whether directly or indirectly, the United States remains the ultimate chessmaster in West Asian geopolitics. Pakistan is already heavily embroiled in Afghanistan while simultaneously facing a critical breaking point in Balochistan. How can Pakistan keep its commitments under the Makkah Pact amid its own growing regional pressures?

VINOD JOHRI | DELHI

What the US-Iran MoU really means

The issue in the US-Iran MoU is not only what the two sides have agreed upon, but which provisions must be implemented immediately and which form part of the deal. This distinction is important when interpreting the MoU. As the conditions are taken from the MoU, clauses using terms such as "immediate" or "upon signing of the MoU", without stating that they are "part of the deal", appear to be provisions that both sides must follow immediately. Therefore, Clauses 1, 4, 5, 10 and 11 form part of the framework. However, Clause 11, concerning the release of frozen assets, remains disputed. Iran argues that the funds should be released before nuclear negotiations begin, while the US rejects this interpretation.

Clause 11 states that the US will make the frozen assets available upon the "implementation of this MoU", while procedures for releasing the funds will be agreed upon during negotiations.

Meanwhile, Clause 13 states that implementation of Paragraphs 1, 4, 5, 10 and 11 should begin, after which the two sides will negotiate the final deal, including the nuclear issue. This suggests that these provisions are intended to take effect before the final agreement is concluded.

RITI DWIVEDI | INDORE

Safeguarding the electoral process

The Election Commission of India (ECI) is today facing serious questions about its independence, transparency and credibility, particularly over EVMs, electoral irregularities and the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. Opposition parties and civil society groups have repeatedly raised concerns about manipulation of the electoral process. The SIR controversy has intensified these concerns, with reports of around 13.3 crore names being deleted, allegedly depriving genuine voters of their constitutional right to vote.

Significantly, Supreme Court Judge Justice Ujjal Bhuyan observed that wholesale disenfranchisement would be inconsistent with Articles 14 and 326 of the Constitution. If genuine voters are removed without adequate notice, verification and an effective appeal mechanism, the credibility of democracy itself is endangered. Such mass disenfranchisement raises serious questions about the genuineness of earlier election results, including the 2019 and 2024 General Elections and subsequent Assembly elections, particularly in Opposition-ruled States. Questions have also been raised about the functioning of the ECI under CEC Gyanesh Kumar. The Supreme Court must act expeditiously to safeguard electoral integrity and ensure every eligible citizen can exercise the franchise freely.

THARCIUS S FERNANDO | CHENNAI

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY | OCTOBER 7, 2026

Modi @ 25: 25 Years of national service, development and pride

For the past 25 years, Prime Minister Narendra Modi has worked continuously, tirelessly and relentlessly with the determination to build a New India. Despite the poisonous and hateful criticism from opponents, attempts at character assassination, baseless allegations of polarisation and verbal attacks from all sides, Modi has never allowed his eyes to stray from his goal



EKNATH SHINDE

On October 7, 2001, Narendra Modi, a dedicated servant of the nation, took over as Gujarat's Chief Minister. The career of service began and led to the office of Prime Minister of India on May 26, 2014. Looking back, this 25-year trip appears to be more than just the arc of one leader's political career; rather, it has become a chapter in the country's shifting political, social and developmental journey.

The 25-year journey of Prime Minister Narendra Modi is a journey of "service, resolve and dedication." It is a journey reflecting the growing confidence of 1.4 billion Indians. On this occasion, on behalf of Maharashtra's 130 million people and the Shiv Sena, I express my warm congratulations and best wishes to Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

The voice that emerged from the soil of Vadnagar has today become an influential voice representing India's position on the global stage. During his tenure as Chief Minister of Gujarat from October 7, 2001 to May 2014, Modi took several important decisions for the development of the state. He assumed office against the backdrop of the devastating Bhuj earthquake. The pace of rehabilitation, reconstruction and rebuilding in Bhuj and the Kutch region was accelerated.

In 2003, he launched the 'Vibrant Gujarat Global Summit'. Through this summit, major companies and industrialists from across the world were encouraged to invest in Gujarat. The Gujarat model appealed to the people of the country. At the same time, public discontent was growing against the hollow promises made in the name of development, corruption and attempts to fill the coffers of the wealthy in the name of eradicating poverty. Modi transformed the sparks of this discontent into political energy.

There is a significant difference between India before 2014 and India after 2014. When the Prime Minister of a country changes, it is not merely the government that changes — the future of the country changes. And that is precisely the transformation that took place after 2014.

Narendra Modi took oath as the Prime Minister of India on May 26, 2014. Thereafter, the policies of the central government placed particular emphasis on development, infrastructure, digital technology, social welfare and national security.

Through the Jan Dhan Yojana, efforts were made to connect a large number of citizens with the banking system. Direct Benefit Transfer and the digitisation of government services received a major boost. Through the Swachh Bharat Mission, emphasis was placed on sanitation and the construction of toilets. Through schemes such as Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana, Ujjwala Yojana, Jal Jeevan Mission and PM-KISAN, the government undertook historic work in areas including housing, clean cooking fuel, piped water supply and direct financial assistance to farmers.

The expansion of Digital India and UPI brought about a major transformation in the field of digital transactions. The expansion of highways, railways, airports and other infrastructure was accelerated. Initiatives such as Make in India, Startup India and Atmanirbhar Bharat are giving a boost to domestic manufacturing, investment and entrepreneurship.

The New Education Policy, new criminal laws and the law against triple talaq were also introduced during the Modi government's tenure. The Modi government also demonstrated the political courage to take the historic decision to abrogate Article 370 in Jammu and Kashmir. The numerous decisions taken over the past 12 years have had a broad and highly positive impact on the direction of Indian politics, the economy, administration and social policy.

Alongside the development agenda, efforts were also made during this period to bring India's cultural heritage to the centre stage. The construction of the Shri Ram Temple in Ayodhya and the grand ceremony of the consecration of Ram Lalla, the development of Kashi Vishwanath Dham and Mahakal Lok, as well as the development of various pilgrimage



sites, have highlighted religious tourism and cultural heritage.

Under the concept of 'Vikas Ke Saath Virasat' - development along with heritage — emphasis has been placed on preserving India's cultural heritage alongside modern infrastructure.

Women's empowerment has been another important component of the Central Government's development agenda. From Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao to Lakhpati Didi, and from Ujjwala and Mudra to self-help groups, various schemes have been implemented to increase women's economic and social participation.

In Maharashtra too, the Mahayuti government has taken several decisions in the same direction for women's empowerment. Whether it is the Mukhyamantri Majhi Ladki Bahin Yojana or the decision to provide higher education to girls — the principle is clear: when a woman becomes empowered, the family becomes empowered; when the family becomes empowered, society becomes empowered; and the strength of the nation grows.

There have also been several important developments in the areas of national security and foreign policy during the Modi government's tenure. India has adopted a more assertive position on the issue of cross-border terrorism. On issues such as BRICS, the Global South, climate change, digital technology, yoga and international cooperation, India has articulated its own distinct position.

Today, India's voice is firmly heard on major global platforms. India's growing economic, strategic and diplomatic capabilities have gained significance. The credit for creating a new and capable identity for India at the international level goes to Modi.

That is why Modi has been honoured with the highest civilian awards of nearly 36 countries.

The 12-year period of the Central Government under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi has also been important for Maharashtra's infrastructure and economic development. The assistance received by Maharashtra from the Centre has not been limited merely to funding; it has also helped accelerate several long-term projects.

Between 2004 and 2014, the decade before 2014, the Central Government provided ₹2 lakh crore for development works in Maharashtra. Between 2014 and 2024, Maharashtra received ₹12 lakh crore in funding.

There has also been a substantial increase in railway allocations. The average annual allocation during 2009-2014 was ₹1,171 crore, while in 2026-27 it has reached ₹23,926 crore.

At present, infrastructure projects worth approximately ₹1.5 lakh crore are underway in the state. Under the Amrit Bharat Station Scheme, redevelopment work is underway at 128 railway stations.

Projects such as the Atal Setu, Samruddhi Mahamarg, Mumbai Coastal Road, Navi Mumbai International Airport, Mumbai-Ahmedabad Bullet Train, and the ₹76,000-crore Vadhavan Port, which will be important for the industrial development of Konkan and Palghar, are in every sense game-changing projects for Maharashtra.

Through welfare schemes as well, citizens of Maharashtra are benefiting from Central Government programmes. Under the Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana, houses for 18 lakh poor families had been completed by May 2026. Through the Jal Jeevan Mission, the proportion of rural households receiving piped water supply increased from 33 per cent to 89 per cent. Eligible farmers in the state are receiving direct financial assistance through the PM-KISAN scheme.

Alongside Maharashtra's development, the state's cultural and historical identity has also received importance through decisions taken by the Central Government. The inclusion of the historic forts of Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj in the UNESCO World Heritage List, the development of the Panch Teerth associated with Babasaheb Ambedkar, and the decision to grant classical language status to Marathi are important milestones for Maharashtra.

The late Shiv Sena chief, Hindu Hriday Samrat Balasaheb Thackeray, had on several occasions clearly articulated his position regarding the politics of Hindutva in the context of Gujarat and Narendra Modi. The dialogue surrounding Hindutva has a long history in the political journeys of Maharashtra and Gujarat. Therefore, this thread of political and social relations between Maharashtra and Narendra Modi is also significant.

It is my great fortune that I have been blessed with the personal affection of the respected Prime Minister Narendra Modi, as has my entire family. The affection shown to me by Modi filled the void created in my life by the passing of Shiv Sena chief Balasaheb Thackeray and Dharmaveer Anand Dighe and gave me tremendous strength.

At every meeting, he asks me, "Kaise hain Eknathji?" and places his hand on my shoulder. At that moment, a new confidence emerges, a new sense of hope is created, and I gain the strength to work with even greater determination for Maharashtra's progress. This bond of affection will always remain special to me.

For the past 25 years, Prime Minister Narendra Modi has worked continuously, tirelessly and relentlessly with the determination to build a New India. Despite the poisonous and hateful criticism from opponents, attempts at character assassination, baseless allegations of polarisation and verbal attacks from all sides, Modi has never allowed his eyes to stray from his goal.

Over the past 25 years, Narendra Modi's responsibilities have changed and his positions have changed; however, his resolve and determination to serve the nation have not diminished even slightly.

This 25-year journey is not merely the duration of one person's political career. It is an important chapter in the political and developmental journey of a changing India. From Gujarat to Delhi, and from there towards the vision of Viksit Bharat 2047, this journey is now looking towards its next phase.

The next major goal is "Viksit Bharat 2047" — a Developed India by 2047. It is a vision of building an economically strong, technologically advanced, self-reliant and secure India.

The vision seeks to create an India that provides opportunities to the poor, gives wings to the dreams of its youth, provides women with equal opportunities and leadership, and takes pride in its cultural heritage.

Recently, while speaking with the Prime Minister, Captain Smit Machhar, who saved the lives of 174 aircraft passengers by displaying presence of mind, said that he had drawn inspiration from the Prime Minister. Such incidents highlight the personal influence of Modi's leadership and the image he has created in the public consciousness.

The records of popularity and tenure may be associated with the names of many leaders. But in the case of Narendra Modi, what is measured is not merely the number of days in office, but the scale of the decisions taken during his tenure and the political influence he has built. My heartfelt best wishes to Modi ji for his journey ahead. I pray that God blesses him with good health, a long life and immense strength to continue serving the nation.

The writer is the Deputy Chief Minister of Maharashtra

Made in India chips, countless possibilities



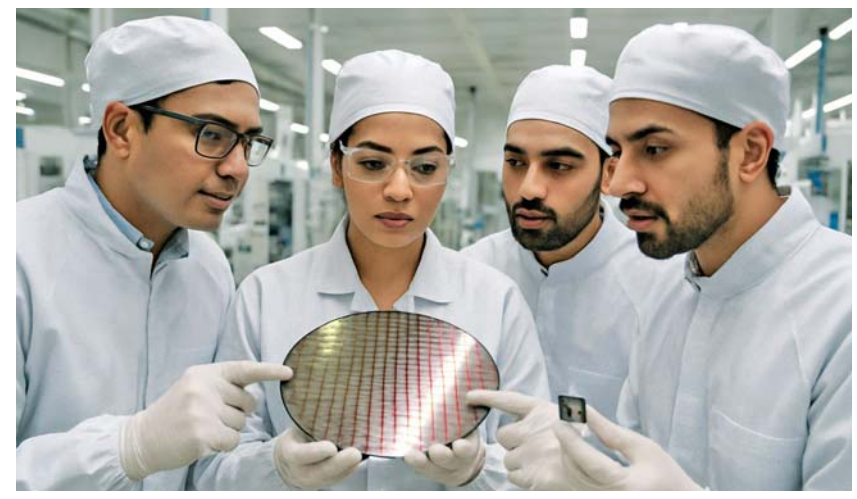
DHARMENDRA TEWARI

Every nation that has reached the front rank did so through a revolution of its own. The countries that seized the Industrial Revolution still shape the world's politics and markets. India has its own examples. The Green Revolution ended our dependence on imported grain, and the White Revolution turned a milk-short country into a dairy giant. The formula is consistent: the entrepreneur reads the market, the government reads the technology, both read the world, and together they make bold calls. A third such moment is arriving now, and it is etched in silicon.

Chips are the brains of every machine. For decades, India mostly bought them from abroad. Only a handful of specialised chips, built for research, defence and space, were made at home, which kept us on the consumer side of the electronics world. That is changing fast. Cars and buses now carry layers of electronics, kitchens and clinics run on embedded intelligence, and in the age of AI, a chip's worth lies in making complex decisions both accurately and quickly. No country wants to depend on others for something so central to daily life and national security.

Consider what a chip actually does. Wired to the other components on a board, it weighs the available options and decides how to carry out each instruction, one task after another, in a fraction of a second. That ability to decide turns a plain device into a smart one, and it is why demand for advanced chips keeps climbing worldwide.

I got a close look at this shift at Semicon 2026 in Delhi, held from September 17 to 19. Thousands of young people from across the country filled the halls, and the mood was unmistakably that of a nation finding its feet. At one Indian company's stall, a homegrown chip priced at just ₹100 caught my eye. Called Ahisa, it is the core component behind devices that spread a broadband connection across a housing society or an office. India used to import such parts; now it exports Ahisa to several countries. Entrepreneurs designing chips for very different jobs were also on show, and the sheer variety made the point plainly: a chip revolution is under way.



Other stalls told similar stories. Netrasemi, an Indian firm, displayed a chip priced at around ₹1,000 that powers AI cameras for residential societies, alerting a control room the moment rules are broken. The same company makes a chip that watches a driver's face and sounds an alarm at the first sign of drowsiness, a quiet but potentially life-saving feature for buses and cars. Elsewhere I saw chips for curtains that open and close from a phone, and one that replaces the costly motor in kitchen appliances, so a young engineer can build a mixer or grinder far more cheaply. Many such components still reach our market from China. What matters is that Indian designers are now building alternatives.

Behind the startups stands the state. The Semiconductor Mission, now in its second phase, is meant to give entrepreneurs room to build. Amitesh Sinha, a senior officer at the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology, told me that substantial ground has been covered in five years and that the country stands at an inflection point. Public institutions are doing their share. At C-DAC's stall, scientists displayed the supercomputer Param Vidya and the Indian server Rudra, which gives research students access to material from reputed institutions worldwide. Once the indigenous microprocessor Om is ready, servers like Rudra can become fully Indian. At C-MET, I saw hafnium, a metal found in India, where a tiny piece was priced in lakhs. Hafnium oxide serves as an insulator inside chips, particularly memory chips. C-MET works on raising the purity of such materials, and its Director General, R Rateesh, said several entrepreneurs had enquired about them during the show. Domestic supply and domestic refining of materials like this is how self-reliance reaches the foundations.

The ambition does not stop at meeting our own needs. A democracy with a reputation for reliability is well placed to supply the world, especially developing countries that want assurance that the chips behind their everyday electronics will not run dry. The India Semiconductor Mission 2 is built around that promise. Even a simple phone assistant needs two things: a language model that understands Indian languages, and a powerful chip underneath it.

I belong to Generation X, which remembers being denied advanced computing technology from abroad. That denial pushed our scientists to build Param, India's first supercomputer, in the transistor era. Today Param Vidya extends that lineage, a foundation laid for the generations after us. For Gen Z and Gen Alpha, the opportunity is larger still. Engineers, designers, materials scientists and scholars from many fields can find a place in this ecosystem. The next few years will decide how far we go. Technology has been bent to destructive ends before, which is why a peace-loving country like India carries a particular responsibility to lead in it. Our culture, traditions and lived experience hold a deep understanding of how to ease ordinary lives.

What is needed is an environment where responsible technology and a trusted global image reinforce each other. If we pair the chip revolution with the old Indian wisdom of balanced development, jobs will follow, everyday hardships will ease at low cost, and India will earn its place as a responsible digital nation.

The writer is a PIB official

Delhi's clean-air battle moves from promises to action



RAJKUMAR BHATIA

Every November, Delhi holds its breath, quite literally. Schools shut, construction stops, the elderly stay indoors and families who can afford it buy one more air purifier. The families who cannot afford it simply breathe what the city gives them. We have lived with this cycle for years. Pollution never lacked political debate in Delhi. There were committees, odd-even experiments, smog towers and full-page advertisements blaming someone else. What was missing was action that actually reached the common household. That action has now begun. Under Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, the Delhi Government has taken two decisions whose effect will be felt not in press conferences but in people's homes and on their daily commute — rooftop solar at zero upfront cost for ordinary families and a new Electric Vehicle Policy. Both stand firmly on the national vision of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, through PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana and PM E-DRIVE. When the Centre and the State work in the same direction, schemes stop being files and start becoming rooftops.

"Muft Bijli" that a family can own

Free electricity has been Delhi's favourite political slogan for ten years. But there is a difference between free electricity handed out as a subsidy and free electricity produced on your own roof. The first depends on the government's budget every year and the family owns nothing. The second is a productive asset that belongs to the household and keeps working for 25 years.

This is what the new solar policy offers. Under PM Surya Ghar, the Centre gives up to ₹78,000 for a rooftop system. The Delhi Government now adds support of up to another ₹78,000 of its own. A family using up to 400 units a month can get a system of up to 3 kW installed without paying a single rupee upfront. Maintenance is free for the first five years, the existing electricity subsidy continues and any surplus power can go back to the grid, reducing the family's bill and creating additional value.

On September 21, 2026, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta launched the registration portal, www.solar.delhi.gov.in, where any eligible family can apply online. Power Minister Ashish Sood rightly described the scheme as one that gives residents free electricity as well as a chance to earn from it. The target is to reach 2.3 lakh families by March 2027, and applications have been coming in steadily since the portal opened.

The smallest house, the biggest gain

Think of a family living in a two-room house on a 25-square-yard plot in a resettlement colony. The husband drives an e-rickshaw, the wife runs a small tailoring business from home and the children study under a single fan. For such a family, rooftop solar was always something for bungalows



in South Delhi. Spending two lakh rupees on panels was simply unthinkable.

That is exactly the family this policy is meant for. The scheme now covers homes with limited roof space, and even a small system of one or two kilowatts on a small roof can meet most of the monthly needs of a modest household. For the first time, the poorest homes in Delhi are not at the end of the queue for clean energy. They are at the front of it. This is real empowerment and it is Antyodaya in practice. Pandit Deendayal Upadhyaya taught that development must be judged by the rise of the last person in society, and that vision has guided the BJP from its very beginning. Here, the family at the end of the line is the first to benefit.

And here lies the political difference. Free power given as a subsidy keeps a citizen dependent on the government. Free power from one's own roof makes him independent. Those who built their politics on the slogan of free electricity for ten years must answer one simple question - why did rooftop solar remain a luxury of the few during their entire tenure? Delhi did not need more promises of "muft Bijli". It needed a way for the poorest family to own it.

The same thinking runs through the Delhi EV Policy 2026, which came into force on July 1, 2026. A young delivery worker, a college student or a small shopkeeper buying an electric scooter can now get up to ₹30,000 in support, paid directly into the bank account, with no middlemen. Road tax and registration fees on eligible electric vehicles have been waived. Auto-rickshaw drivers, who spend most of their earnings on fuel, will move to cheaper electric autos in a planned way. Thousands of families applied for incentives within weeks of the scheme opening.

For those who cannot buy a vehicle at all, the change is visible at the bus stop. Under Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, Delhi now runs more than 5,000 electric buses, the largest such fleet in the country. The small DEVI buses reach narrow colony lanes where large buses never went, and women travel free. A cleaner commute has become available to the ordinary Delhiite, not only to those who drive a car.

Clean air and Aatmanirbhar Bharat

There is a larger purpose behind all this. India imports most of the crude oil it uses, and every scooter that runs on Indian electricity instead of imported petrol strengthens our energy security. Under PM Surya Ghar, the Central subsidy requires domestically manufactured solar modules using domestically manufactured cells. So every rooftop in Delhi means work for Indian factories and for the young electricians, installers and technicians in our own colonies who will set up and maintain these systems. Clean air, lower bills and local jobs are all part of the same Aatmanirbhar Bharat.

A good scheme succeeds only when it reaches the last house. As public representatives, we must take this scheme door to door. Every MLA, councillor and RWA can hold solar camps in the colonies, help families register on the portal and guide them through the process. Inspections and meter connections must be quick and simple, so that no poor family gives up halfway. Housing societies should be encouraged to set up common solar systems with charging points for electric scooters. And because pollution does not stop at Delhi's border, closer coordination with our neighbouring States will multiply the benefit.

For too long, Delhi's pollution debate has revolved around who was to blame. A government must begin with what lies within its own control. Clean buses are within its control. Solar on the roofs of the poor is within its control. Making electric vehicles affordable for the common man is within its control. Under Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, Delhi has finally started acting on all three.

The buses are on the road. The incentives are reaching buyers. The solar portal is open, and families from the smallest houses are applying. The task now is to keep going until November in Delhi once again means the arrival of winter, not the arrival of a health emergency.

The writer is presently a Member of the Delhi Legislative Assembly and the convenor of the social initiative 'Roti Bank'

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CJI administers oath to three new judges

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Chief Justice Surya Kant on Tuesday administered oath of office to three new judges elevated to the Supreme Court, taking its working strength to 37, one short of the sanctioned 38.

Justices Sunita Agarwal, Devendra Kumar Upadhyaya and Aparesh Kumar Singh took oath in the auditorium of the new Supreme Court block.

All the Supreme Court judges, judicial officers and officials from different high courts were present on the occasion.

Family members and lawyers from the Supreme Court and other high courts were also present during the ceremony.

On Monday, Union Law Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal made the announcement about the Government clearing the names of the three judges.

The Supreme Court Collegium had recommended the names on September 28. While the current working strength of the apex court is 34 and upon swearing in of the three new judges, the effective strength has gone up to 37. The top court's sanctioned strength is 38 judges, including the Chief Justice of India. It was recently increased from 34 following the Supreme Court Amendment Act, 2026.



CJI Surya Kant administers oath of office to newly appointed SC judge Sunita Agarwal during a swearing-in ceremony in New Delhi PTI

With Justice Sunita Agarwal's appointment, the number of women judges in the top court has gone up to three, including Justice B V Nagarathna, who has been a judge in the top court since August 31, 2021, and Justice Venkita Subramani Mohana, who was appointed on June 2, 2026.

While Justice Agarwal and Justice Nagarathna have a background of serving in high courts, Justice Mohana was elevated directly from the Bar. She had been a senior advocate of the Supreme Court. Justice Nagarathna will also become the Chief Justice of India for less than a month in 2027.Justices Agarwal and Upadhyay originally are from the Allahabad High Court, while Justice Singh belongs to the Jharkhand High Court.Justice Agarwal was Chief Justice of the Gujarat High Court, Justice Upadhyaya was Chief Justice of the Delhi High Court while Justice Aparesh Kumar Singh was the Chief Justice of the Telangana High Court.

Justice Sunita Agarwal was born on April 30, 1966 and was enrolled as an advocate with the UP Bar Association on December 16, 1990.

After a dedicated practice of 21 years, Justice Agarwal was elevated as additional judge of Allahabad High Court on November 21, 2011 and, thereafter, took oath as a permanent judge on August 6, 2013.

After serving as a judge in Allahabad High Court for 12 years, Justice Agarwal was appointed as the Chief Justice of Gujarat High Court on July 23, 2023. Justice Upadhyaya was born on June 16 1965 at village Muskarai of Ambedkar Nagar district of Uttar Pradesh. He graduated in law in the year 1991 from Lucknow University and enrolled as an advocate on May 11, 1991.

He was appointed as the chief standing counsel for Uttar Pradesh in May 2007 and continued to hold that office till his elevation as judge of the Allahabad High Court. He was appointed as a puisne judge of the Allahabad High Court on November 21, 2011 and took oath as the permanent judge on August 6, 2013.

Justice Upadhyaya took oath as the Chief Justice of the Bombay High Court on July 29, 2023 and was transferred as the Delhi High Court Chief Justice on January 21, 2025.

Order Order

SC asks NHAI to track parked vehicles on highways



The Supreme Court on Tuesday asked why can't the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) have an electronic surveillance mechanism to immediately track stationary or parked vehicles on highways.

The observation came from a bench of justices Vikram Nath, Augustine George Masih and Sandeep Mehta which was hearing a suo motu case related to a November 2025 road accident in Rajasthan's Phalodi area that claimed 15 lives. Senior advocate A N S Nadkarni, who is assisting the top court as amicus curiae in the matter, referred to some recent road accidents caused due to parking of vehicles on highways. "Why can't the NHAI, which has got all the resources with it, have some kind of an electronic surveillance mechanism by which any vehicle found stationary or parked on the highways be immediately tracked," the bench observed.One of the advocates appearing in the matter said the NHAI does patrolling on the highways.The bench was informed that several interlocutory applications have been filed in the matter. The top court posted the matter for October 13 and said it would deal with the applications concerning removal of encroachments from the highways. (*PNS*)

HC seeks Salman Khan's response to Kala Hiran producer's plea

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

The Delhi High Court sought actor Salman Khan's response on a plea by makers of the film "Kala Hiran: The Battle for Legal" seeking to stay the Bollywood star's suit against the release of the movie.

Justice Anup Jairam Bhambhani issued a notice to



Khan on the makers' application, which argued that same dispute is already pending before the high court .

The movie's producer Amit Jani contended that the proceedings amount to parallel litigation concerning the same proposed film, promotional material and alleged infringement of the actor's personality or publicity rights.

SC to hear Punjab Government plea against HC's CBI corruption probe

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Tuesday agreed to hear the Punjab Government's plea seeking a stay on a high court direction to the CBI to investigate corruption allegations against people linked to the AAP-led Government and submit a report within two months.

A bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana said it will hear the



matter on Wednesday or Thursday after senior advocate Vikas Singh, appearing for the state government, sought its urgent listing. Singh, while mentioning the matter for urgent listing, said that during election time, these kinds of cases are being trumped up.

CJI Kant observed that the court will see how many matters are there and till then, nothing will happen. Singh persisted with the request and said that it's a clear case of federal structure being violated. On October 5, the state Government moved the top court against the Punjab and Haryana High Court's direction passed Monday on a petition filed by advocate Nikhil Saraf.

PepsiCo, Monster win relief in Delhi HC energy drink case

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

The Delhi High Court on Tuesday ordered no coercive action against PepsiCo and Monster Beverages, which have been directed by the FSSAI to drop the descriptor "energy drink" from its beverages.

The court allowed the two companies to sell their existing stocks of beverages labelled as "energy drink" but made it clear that they cannot manufacture any more products bearing the descriptor. "Your existing stocks will be sold," Justice Amit Mahajan said while passing the order.

While PepsiCo manufactures Sting Energy and Adrenaline Rush, Monster Beverages sells its product under the name Monster Energy.PepsiCo and Monster approached the high court challenging the orders passed by the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) directing them to drop the label "energy drink".

NORTHERN RAILWAY
E-AUCTION NOTICE
No: C-12/San/SWM/2026 **Dated : 05.10.2026**
Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/PS, Northern Railway Delhi Division invites bids through e-Auction through IREPS (**http://ireps.gov.in/**) for Solid Waste Management at following 27 Nominated Railway stations/locations:

E-Catalogue No.	Date & Time of bidding	Railway Stations/Locations/Sites
SWM-DLIDIV-26-1	Dated 21.10.2026 at 15:00 Hrs	SOLID WASTE MANAGEMENT AT RAILWAY STATIONS OVER DELHI DIVISION- CONTRACT FOR COLLECTION, TRANSPORTATION, RECYCLING AND SCIENTIFIC PROCESSING OF SEGREGATED WET, DRY RECYCLABLE, SANITARY, SPECIAL-CARE AND INERT WASTE AT 27 DESIGNATED BULK WASTE GENERATOR (BWG) RAILWAY STATIONS OVER DELHI DIVISION NAMELY NEW DELHI, DELHI, HAZRAT NIZAMUDDIN, ANAND VIHAR, DELHI SARAI ROHILLA, GHAZIABAD, MEERUT CITY, MUZAFFARNAGAR, DELHI CANTT, PANIPAT, SONIPAT, ROHTAK, GURGAON, FARIDABAD, KARNAL, KURUKSHETRA, SAHIBABAD, BAHADURGARH, PALWAL, SHAKURBASTI, SUBZI MANDI, GANAUR, NARELA, BALLABHGARH, DELHI SADAR BAZAR, BADLI & FARIDABAD NEW TOWN OVER DELHI DIVISION FOR A PERIOD OF 05 YEARS, IN ACCORDANCE WITH SOP FOR SOLID WASTE MANAGEMENT RULES, 2026 ISSUED BY RAILWAY BOARD. Total 27 Railway Stations of Delhi Division

Website particulars where complete details of E-Auction can be seen: **https://ireps.gov.in/**

All contractors who intend to participate in the e-auctions conducted through E-Auction Leasing module of IREPS should fulfil following mandatory requirements before they can submit their bids:
• Registration on IREPS for E-Auction Leasing module - Active IREPS User Account for E-Auction Leasing Module • Payment of One Time Registration Fee; Current Account in State Bank of India; Integration of SBI Bank Account with IREPS Account; Lien Marking of Funds; Updation of Turnover Details • A new mechanism namely Virtual Account Number (VAN) has been introduced now for E Auction Leasing module, which can be used by the bidders as an alternative to Lien Marking Mechanism. The bidders are free to switch between Lien Marking Mechanism (if activated) and VAN mechanism at any point of time, before entering the bidding room. VAN mechanism does not require the bidder to have a current account in State Bank of India. The users are free to transfer money from any of their existing bank accounts in any bank to their VAN account, which enables them to participate in IREPS E-Auctions. • Contractors who do not have IREPS account for any module of IREPS can submit their online request for registration by clicking on New Vendors / Contractors (E-Tender /E-Auction Leasing) link on IREPS Home page.

Railway Authority to contact, in case of any query: Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Commercial Branch, State Entry Road, New Delhi 110055. Email:**sanitationcell@gmail.com** Tel: 011- 23743084

Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/PS
Northern Railway, Delhi Division
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 3448/26

दि बाजपुर को-आपरेटिव शुगर फैक्ट्री लि0,
बाजपुर, जिला-ऊधमसिंह नगर (उत्तराखण्ड)
पत्रांक: का0अधी0/2026-27/1270 **ई–निविदा सूचना** दिनाँक: 06.10.2026
पेराई सत्र 2026–27 हेतु लूज बैगास (चीनी मिल की) आपूर्ति, सामग्री / कार्यों व मिल की 20 एकड़ भूमि (19 एकड़ कृषि योग्य) को 03 वर्ष के लिए ठेके पर दिये जाने हेतु उत्तराखण्ड अधिप्राप्ति (प्रोक्योरमेन्ट) नियमावली–2025 के नियमानुसार (**Two Bid System**) के अन्तर्गत ई–निविदायें **www.uktenders.gov.in** पर आमंत्रित की जाती है। अन्य माध्यम से प्राप्त निविदा स्वीकार्य नही होंगी। आवश्यकता होने पर **L-1/H-1** (न्यूनतम / प्रथम उच्चतम) दरदाता से नेगोशिऐसन किया जायेगा। जिसकी विस्तृत निविदा सूचना व निविदा प्रपत्र **www.uktenders.gov.in** से डाउनलोड की जा सकेगी। निविदा में किसी भी प्रकार के संशोधन की दशा में संशोधन का प्रकाशन केवल **www.uktenders.gov.in** के माध्यम से ही प्रकाशित किया जायेगा।
प्रधान प्रबन्धक

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Tender Notice NO. 47/2026-2027 Dated: 06.10.2026
Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement system
Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

S. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01	07260213	AIR SPRING SET	96 SET	29.10.26
02	77269033 A-RGC	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR CHECK RAILS 9.5M LONG TO RDSO	500 SET	29.10.26
03	19255052 B	BLOWER FOR OIL COOLING UNIT WITH CASING	196 NOS	02.11.26
04	77269031 RGC	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR C.I. FITTINGS FOR 1 IN 12 THICK WEB SWITCHES	100 SET	02.11.26
05	77269041 A-RGC	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR 1M LONG FISH PLATE	4880 NOS	19.11.26
06	77269038 RGC	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR 06MM NCR GRSP	250 SET	20.11.26

NOTE- 1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. **www.ireps.gov.in** for details. **2.** No Manual offer will be entertained. 3458/26
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

UPSIDA कार्यालय वरिष्ठ प्रबन्धक (वि0/यी0), विद्युत खण्ड-द्वितीय
उ0प्र0 राज्य औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण
प्रशासनिक भवन, सेक्टर सी-3, इन्द्रा दिल्ली सिम्बोस्र डिटी, लोनी, गाजियाबाद, E-Mail-ed2@upsida.co.in
शुद्धिपत्र
एतद् द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि दिनांक 17.09.2026 को समाचार पत्रों में प्रकाशित यूपीसीडा के औद्योगिक क्षेत्र में कविनगर, गाजियाबाद में स्थापित स्ट्रीट लाइटों के 03 वर्षों तक अनुरक्षण एवं मरम्मत के कार्य से सम्बन्धित निविदा आमंत्रित की गयी है, जिनकी टेण्डर आईडी 2026_SIDC_1186697_1 है, जो दिनांक 17.09.2026 से दिनांक 06.10.2026 तक अपलोड की जानी थी एवं दिनांक 07.10.2026 को खोली जानी है, अपरिहार्य कारणों से अब उक्त आमंत्रित ई–निविदा दिनांक 14.10.2026 की सायं 6:00 बजे तक निविदा प्रपत्र अपलोड किए जाने हेतु विस्तारित किया जाता है, जिन्हें दिनांक 15.10.2026 को प्रातः 11:00 बजे खोली जायेगी। शेष नियम व शर्तें यथावत रहेंगी। निविदा से सम्बन्धित अधिक जानकारी हेतु श्री प्रवेश गिरी, प्रबन्धक (वि0), दूरभाष नं0 9927030700 पर सम्पर्क कर सकते हैं।
वरिष्ठ प्रबन्धक, उ0प्र0रा0औ0वि0प्रा0, गाजियाबाद

PUBLIC NOTICE
I, hereby inform to the Public at large that my clients Mrs. Kulwinder Kaur Bhambra wife of Late Hardev Singh R/o B-16, Sawan Park, Delhi-110052, has severed off / disconnected her all relations / connections with her son Shri Ronit Bhambra, and his wife Mrs. Samridhi Kakkar. She has debarred / disowned them from her all moveable / immoveable properties, for all intents and purposes. If anybody deals with them, he / she shall be fully responsible for all future consequences.
NIRANJAN SINGH TOMAR (Advocate)
RU-368, 1st Floor, Pitampura, Delhi-110034

The Pioneer CLASSIFIED
CHANGE OF NAME

I, No. 15414786H HAV/DVR (MT) Ingle Surajkumar Shrirang, R/o- Vill & PO- Takli Viro, Teh- Shegaon, Dist- Buldana, Maharashtra- 444203, have changed my daughter's name from Tanvi Ingle to Tanvi Surajkumar Ingle, vide affidavit dated 06/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Riti Sarkar, W/o No.14839988M Nk Khokan Sarkar, R/o- Khanda Bhangni Po- Koalidaha, Dist- Coochbehar, West Bengal - 736135, have changed my name from Riti Sarkar to Riti Sarkar Modak, vide affidavit dated 06/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Maya Ingle, W/o No.15414786H HAV/DVR (MT) Ingle Surajkumar Shrirang, R/o- Vill & PO- Takli Viro, Teh- Shegaon, Dist- Buldana, Maharashtra- 444203, have changed my name from Maya Ingle to Maya Surajkumar Ingle, vide affidavit dated 06/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Saty Prakash Son of Shri Dalbir Singh, R/o Kalyanpur, Sharifpur, Mainpuri, Uttar Pradesh-205265 declare that I have changed my name as Saty Prakash from Satya Prakash. I shall be known as Saty Prakash from today for all purposes.

I, SAVITRI AWASTHI, W/o Ravindra Kumar Awasthi, R/o Johwa Sharki, PO: Johwasarki; Distt: Rae Bareli (U.P) 229303 have changed my name from Savitri Awasthi to Savitri Devi. Henceforth, I would be known by the name of SAVITRI DEVI for all future purposes.

PUBLIC NOTICE
Notice is hereby given on behalf of **Shri Shiv Chaitanya Brahmchari Educational Society and Mr. Krishan Kumar Bhardwaj and Mrs. Suman Bhardwaj** who are owners of land area 10 Kanal 12 Marla 7 Sarsai falling in Mustakil and Kila no.215//13(8-0), 11 Khasra no.215//8(8-0), 9(8-0), & Khasra no.215//2/1(4-0), **&** Mu No. 202, Kila No. 19(4-0), 20(6-8), 21/1(3-18), 22(8-0), 26(1-15) & Mu No. 203 Kila No. 16(8-0), 17/1(4-0) & Mu. No. 215 Kila No. 2/2(4-0), 3(8-0), & Mu No. 215 Kila No. 1/2 (6-0) Mu No. 215 Kila No. 10(6-13), 11/1(2-9), **&** Mu. No. 215 Kila No. 1/2(6-0), situated at Bohrakala, Tehsil-Farukh Nagar, District-Gurgaon, Haryana vide Exchange Deed dated 29.05.2003, Exchange Deed dated 26.08.2003, Regd. Will dated 07.12.2010, Sale Deed dated 05.05.2010, Sale Deed dated 30.01.2019, Sale Deed dated 06.04.2018, Transfer Deed dated 25.09.2026, That Original Exchange Deed dated 26.08.2003 document no.880, Gift Deed dated 29.05.2003 Document No. 306, Sale Deed dated 06.05.2010 Document no.278, Sale Deed dated 02.06.2017 Document No. 518 has been misplaced/lost/not traceable and FIR of the same has been filed bearing application no.132270812601553 with Haryana Police Citizen Services (online portal), now **Shri Shiv Chaitanya Brahmchari Educational Society and Mr. Krishan Kumar Bhardwaj and Mrs. Suman Bhardwaj** intend to mortgage the subject property with **AXIS FINANCE LTD**, So, to comply the requirements of BANK/NBFC, we give this public notice that if any Person having any type of claim/right/title/interest/creating mortgage over the said property, may inform in writing, at the address mentioned below, about his objections, within **07 days** from today, failing which it shall be presumed that the said property is free from all type of Encumbrances, lien etc. **Lucem Legal LLP N-161, Ground Floor, Saira Tower, Gautam Nagar Near Yusuf Sarai Community Centre,New Delhi-110049 Contact # 011-40046316 & 41667327**

INDIAN COAST GUARD



Online Registration through https://www.ssc.gov.in is available from 06 Oct 26 (1100 HRS) to 21 Oct 26 (1730 HRS).

Note: 1. For detailed advertisement and procedure to fill online application please visit **https:// www.ssc.gov.in**.
2. Please read the instructions given in the website carefully before submitting your online application form. This is an indicative Advertisement only.

Disclaimer. Information published in various News Papers is for guidelines only. In case of any ambiguity regarding eligibility criteria, date, time of examination and other procedures, the contents given in website ***https:// www.ssc.gov.in*** will be final.

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cbc 10119/11/0002/2627

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY | OCTOBER 7, 2026

White gold, new dawn: India's journey from cotton heritage to new age fibre leadership



GIRIRAJ SINGH



Every year on 7 October, World Cotton Day reminds us that some of the strongest threads of a nation's future are woven from the strength of its past. For thousands of years, India has spun and woven cotton, creating fabrics so fine that Indian muslin came to be described as "woven air". Cotton, therefore, has never been merely a commodity for India. It is woven into our civilisation, our economy and our national journey.

Today, that legacy stands even stronger. India is the world's second-largest cotton producer and the largest cotton-growing nation by acreage, with nearly 115.25 lakh hectares under cultivation, more than one-third of the world's cotton acreage. India is the only country in the world to commercially cultivate all four species of cotton. Nearly six million farmers depend directly on this crop, while millions more are connected through ginning, spinning, weaving, and garmenting. Cotton remains India's White Gold, a source of livelihoods, industrial strength and rural prosperity. It accounts for around 60 per cent of India's textile fibre consumption, compared with about 30 per cent globally. This reflects the depth of our cotton-based textile ecosystem, but it also places a responsibility on us: to make every hectare more productive, every bale higher quality, and every farmer better rewarded.

For many years, India's cotton sector has carried the weight of persistent challenges: low productivity, heavy dependence on rain-fed cultivation, climate and pest risks, uneven access to modern technology, and concerns over fibre quality. Under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, the scale, ambition, and integration of the response have changed. We are approaching it as a complete value chain, from the seed and the farmer to ginning, spinning, manufacturing and global markets.

The Mission for Cotton Productivity-Kapas Kanti, with an outlay of more than 5,000 crore, reflects this approach. Its ambition is clear: to raise cotton lint productivity from 440 kg to 755 kg per hectare and production to 498 lakh bales by 2030-31. It brings together climate-resilient and high-yielding varieties, modern farming practices, farmer demonstrations, scientific research, quality improvement, testing, traceability, and sustainable fibre development

We have expanded MSP procurement to 571 centres and strengthened digital systems to make procurement more transparent and efficient. Through CotBiz (Cotton Seed & Bale Billing System) and BITS (Bale Identification and Traceability System), we are bringing greater efficiency, transparency and traceability to the cotton value chain.

Alongside this, Kasturi Cotton Bharat is giving Indian cotton a distinct identity built on quality, certification, and traceability, helping move Indian cotton beyond being merely a commodity toward becoming a quality-driven, traceable, and globally recognised Indian brand.

But the heart of our transformation is productivity. With around 60 per cent of India's cotton grown in rain-fed areas, improving yields while building resilience is critical. We are therefore taking modern technologies, improved varieties, HDPS, better agronomic practices, and stronger extension to the field. Under conventional cultivation, farmers usually harvested only about 5-7 quintals of seed cotton per acre. With the High Density Planting System (HDPS), using about 5.5 packets of seed and 29,000 plants per acre, yields have risen to around 12 quintals per acre. With our farmers' active partnership, our next goal is to take this to 18 quintals of seed cotton per acre.

But more cotton must also mean better cotton. With lint recovery at around 32-33 per cent, modernising ginning is essential. During my interactions with ginners, I have emphasised quality and efficiency, with modern machinery interventions helping us move lint recovery towards 35 per cent and deliver cleaner, higher-quality Indian cotton to global markets.

India's fibre requirement is projected to rise from around 15 MMT today to nearly 23 MMT by 2030. Cotton alone cannot meet this growing demand. The twenty-first century is now opening a new chapter, driven by the search for renewable, biodegradable and low-carbon materials. India enters this new era with a unique advantage: the natural resources and fibre diversity to develop the materials of tomorrow

New Age Fibres: Building the Next Fibre Economy

This is where New Age Fibres become strategically important. India has known and used many of these fibres for centuries, yet their potential remained largely untapped. We are now taking our fibre agenda beyond cotton, with focused impetus on the research, development and commercialisation of New Age Fibres. Backed by a dedicated 300 crore under the Mission for Cotton Productivity, we are opening new opportunities for farmers, rural enterprises and sustainable manufacturing, and laying the foundation for India to emerge as a global leader in sustainable fibres. We are working across a diverse range, from milkweed, flax, ramie, sisal, kapok and hemp to bamboo, banana, nettle and pineapple leaf fibre.

Milkweed, traditionally known as Aak or Madar and used in offerings to Lord Shiva, is emerging as a promising New Age Fibre, with cultivation expanding to 15-16 acres and around 10,000 kg of floss/fibre extracted from Uttar Pradesh, Haryana and Rajasthan, with potential in insulation, sustainable filling materials, textiles and extreme-cold-climate defence clothing. Sisal is finding applications in automotive interiors, geotextiles, composites, construction reinforcement and sustainable packaging, while Ramie has potential in apparel, denim blends and technical textiles. Pineapple Leaf Fibre (PALF) can turn agricultural residue into fashion textiles, leather alternatives and bio-composites, while banana fibre is used for yarn, paper, handicrafts, furnishings and technical textiles. Bamboo, flax, hemp, nettle and kapok further expand India's sustainable fibre basket across textiles, home furnishings, insulation and technical products.

The opportunity goes far beyond individual fibres. As global demand shifts towards renewable, low-carbon, biodegradable and traceable materials, this diversity becomes a strategic economic asset for India.

India, the motherland of cotton, has carried this legacy for thousands of years. Today, we are ready to take this legacy into the future, not merely as custodians of cotton, but as leaders of the Second Fibre Revolution, driven by New Age Fibres, sustainable materials, innovation and advanced technology. Guided by Honourable Prime Minister Narendra Modi's 5F vision, from Farm to Fibre, Fibre to Factory, Factory to Fashion and Fashion to Foreign markets, we are connecting our rich heritage with the needs of a new world. As the world seeks fibres that are cleaner, greener and fit for the future, India is ready to lead this transformation and shape the next chapter of global textiles.

The writer is the Union Minister of Textiles. The views expressed are personal

Dr Amita Chauhan gets lifetime achievement award for promoting science

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

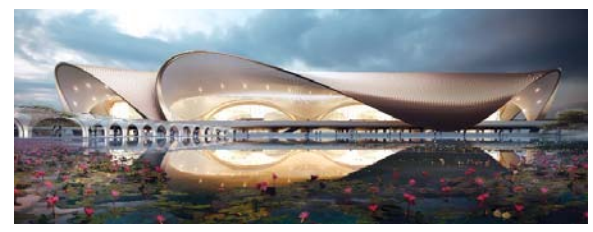


Dr Amita Chauhan, Chairperson, Amity Group of Schools, has been conferred the Lifetime Achievement Award for her significant contribution towards promoting scientific curiosity, innovation and a scientific temperament among young learners.

The Indian Association of Physics Teachers (IAPT-RC1) and Amity Children Science Foundation presented the award during the valedictory ceremony of the 40th National Annual Convention of the Indian Association of Physics Teachers, held at Amity University. Renowned scientist and former IIT Kanpur Professor Professor HC Verma, Additional Director of Education, Delhi, Professor KS Upadhyay, and IAPT National President Professor PK Ahluwalia presented the award.

Expressing her gratitude, Dr Amita Chauhan said, "It is essential to nurture curiosity about science among young minds. At Amity, we encourage students not only to learn science in the classroom but also to engage in research and innovation and develop a scientific temperament. It is a matter of pride that students from Amity schools have filed nearly 230 patents."

Navi Mumbai International Airport expands mobility, hospitality and airline support



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Navi Mumbai

Navi Mumbai International Airport (NMIA), operated by Adani Airport Holdings Limited (AAHL), is strengthening passenger mobility, transit hospitality and airline support as flight activity is set to increase ahead of the winter flying schedule, which runs from October 25, 2026, to March 27, 2027.

Maharashtra State Road Transport Corporation will launch electric e-Shivai services from October 7 to Dadar, Borivali and Pune, with fares of ₹170, ₹210 and ₹450, respectively. Chalo operates 21 daily services to Marol, Bandra, Dadar and Colaba, while Navi Mumbai Municipal Transport runs seven dedicated airport routes. Bharat Taxi will begin operations with up to 40 vehicles from October 10.

GDA demolishes illegal colony in Loni area

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Ghaziabad

The Ghaziabad Development Authority (GDA) on Tuesday carried out a demolition drive against an unauthorised colony being developed on Khasra Nos 373, 374 and 377 in Nawada village, Loni, Ghaziabad.

The action was taken under the relevant provisions of the Uttar Pradesh Urban Planning and Development Act, 1973, under the leadership of the In-charge of Enforcement Zone-08.

According to the GDA, the unauthorised colony was



being developed by Sonu, son of Mohammad Ali, and Sajid, son of Yamin.

During the drive, the team demolished structures and infrastructure at the site, including boundary walls of around 200-250 plots, a site office, electricity poles, roads, and sewer lines.

Local developers and residents strongly opposed the action, but the GDA Police Force brought the situation under control, after which the demolition continued as per procedure. The operation was carried out in the presence of Enforcement Zone-08 staff, GDA Police personnel and the Authority's enforcement team.

The GDA said its campaign against unauthorised development will continue in the coming months, with strict action, including demolition and sealing of unauthorised constructions, as per applicable provisions.

Piyush Goyal meets US business leaders in financial services and technology

SAGAR KULKARNI
Washington



Union Minister of Commerce and Industry Piyush Goyal during a meeting with Mark Tucker, Non-Executive Chairman of AIA Group, to discuss expanding investments in India's insurance and financial services sectors in New York City PTI

Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal met leaders of insurance companies, technology and investment firms and urged them to explore opportunities in their respective sectors in India. Goyal met Mark Tucker, Chairman of the AIA Group; Michel A Khalad, President and CEO of MetLife; William E Ford, Chairman of General Atlantic; and Arvind Krishna, Chairman and CEO of IBM in New York.

"Met Mr Mark Tucker, Non-Executive Chairman of @AIAGroupLimited, one of Asia's largest life insurance groups. Discussed AIA's engagement in India and opportunities to deepen investments in the insurance and financial services sectors," Goyal said in a post on X.

The minister said that with comprehensive regulatory reforms and rising demand for insurance coverage, India offers global insurers an ideal platform for long-term growth, aligned with the national vision of 'Insurance for All by 2047'. Goyal also met Khalaf, President and CEO @MetLife, and exchanged views on the company's growth opportunities in India.

"India's rapidly growing insurance and financial services sector, rising demand for long-term savings and protection, and deep technology talent present exciting opportunities to strengthen collaboration," he said. "We look forward to strengthening our engagement and supporting their journey in India," the minister said. Goyal also held a "productive meeting" with Ford, Chairman & CEO of General Atlantic.

He said he discussed with Ford opportunities for General Atlantic to deepen its business and investment ties with India & further strengthen its engagement with the country, leveraging the opportunities presented by India's growing economy.

Goyal also had a "good meeting" with Krishna, Chairman and CEO of IBM and discussed pathways to build on IBM's longstanding presence in India and deepen collaboration across AI, cloud infrastructure, quantum computing and other frontier technologies, leveraging India's vast talent pool and rapid digital adoption to innovate and scale solutions for the world. (*PTI*)

FM Nirmala Sitharaman calls on Swiss President, discusses BIT negotiations

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman during a meeting with Swiss Confederation President Guy Parmelin in New Delhi PTI

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Tuesday met Swiss President Guy Parmelin here and discussed issues of common interest between India and Switzerland, including taking forward negotiations on the Bilateral Investment Treaty (BIT).

The discussions focused on advancing the BIT negotiations, which will help enhance investment flows and deepen economic engagement, the finance ministry said in a post on X.

The meeting comes as India and Switzerland seek to strengthen bilateral economic ties and facilitate greater investment between the two countries.

"They held discussions on issues of common interest to both India and Switzerland, including taking forward negotiations on the Bilateral Investment Treaty which is mutually beneficial to both nations with a view to enhance investment flows and deepening economic engagement," it said.

A Bilateral Investment Treaty is an agreement between the two countries to promote and protect investments made by their investors in the other's territory. Under investment protection treaties, investors can take a sovereign government to arbitration.

With Outward Direct Investment (ODI) from India increasing, there is a need to ensure that domestic investors and companies investing abroad also get adequate protection.

The current 2016 framework requires a foreign investor to wait for five years before initiating a treaty-based arbitration against India.

This means that if a foreign investor has a dispute with India, it should first pursue domestic remedies for five years before bringing a claim under the agreement.

In the last few years, there has been growing opposition to this five-year period, with many seeking to reduce the duration.



Delhi airport sees rise in passenger traffic: CEO Pradeep Panicker

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Delhi Airport is perhaps a "bright spot" with rising passenger traffic and international airlines' focus on India, its CEO Pradeep Panicker said on Tuesday amid the ongoing West Asia crisis and geopolitical uncertainties impacting the aviation sector.

Airport operator DIAL is also working to enhance infrastructure, airside and terminal capacities, and connectivity in a ten-year master plan charted out till 2036.

Indira Gandhi International Airport (IGIA), operated by Delhi International Airport Ltd (DIAL), is the country's largest airport and currently has an annual passenger handling capacity of 106 million, which is set to increase to 125 million during the latest master plan period.

"Delhi airport is perhaps a bright spot... more passengers travel out of Delhi, and international carriers are continuing to focus on India..." Panicker said.

More European carriers are also flying in here due to the West Asia crisis, and the airport has recorded an overall growth in domestic and international traffic.

He was responding to queries at a briefing related to the impact of the West Asia crisis and Pakistan airspace closure on the flight operations.

According to him, there has been more growth from Asia Pacific than West Asia and that there is a "more robust market".

During the April-August period in 2026-27, traffic from the Asia Pacific region rose 11.4 per cent to 3.57 million compared to 3.21 million in the year-ago period, he said.

He also said traffic from the Middle East region declined 4.1 per cent to 2.37 million in the given period from 2.47 million in April-August of 2025-26.

The traffic from North America and Africa fell 26.2 per cent and 10.9 per cent, respectively, in April-August this fiscal year compared to the year-ago period. There was a marginal uptick of 0.9 per cent in traffic from Europe during the given period.

Overall, Delhi airport's international traffic rose 0.8 per cent to 8.62 million in April-August of 2026-27 from 8.55 million a year ago.

In 2025-26, the overall traffic at the airport was around 78.7 million, and in the current fiscal, the numbers are likely to be around 82 million.

The airport has four runways, a cross taxiway and three terminals - T1, T2 and T3.

To a query related to a proposal to allow airport operators to own a stake in airlines, Panicker said, "We as GMR are not looking to invest in airlines".

FSSAI tells States to step up checks on food adulteration

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Food regulator FSSAI has asked states to increase surveillance for preventing the sale of adulterated and counterfeit food items during the upcoming festival season, as part of the objective to safeguard public health.

In an advisory to all state food commissioners dated September 29, the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) stressed the need to focus on sensitive locations.

With the onset of the upcoming Navratri and Diwali festivals, the demand for sweets, savouries, beverages, edible oil and milk & milk products and other food items rises, the regulator said.

In view of this, the FSSAI stressed the need for "heightened surveillance and enforcement actions to prevent the circulation of adulterated, counterfeited and unsafe food products namely - milk & milk products, sweets, snacks & savouries including namkeen, papad/fryums, edible oil, beverages and ghee."

To safeguard public health, the FSSAI asked state food commissioners to conduct inspections and sampling in their respective areas during the festive period.

NTPC to buy 10-15 MT coal from commercial miners in FY27

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



State-run power giant NTPC is looking to procure 10-15 million tonnes of coal from privately owned commercial coal mines to meet its requirement for dry fuel in FY27. The move is aimed at increasing the availability of coal for electricity generation amid a critical coal stock position, a source said.

"The company would be sourcing 10-15 million tonnes of coal from commercial miners this (fiscal) year. It has spoken to NLC as well," the source said, noting that NTPC plants are running at a PLF of 75-76 per cent.

The shipment will come from commercial mines located in states such as Odisha and West Bengal, the source said.

Plant load factor (PLF) indicates how efficiently a thermal power plant is using its overall capacity.

India's largest power generation player, NTPC, is anticipating a coal requirement of around 300 million tonnes (MT) in FY27, up 11 per cent from FY26 (when CIL and SCCL had jointly supplied 215.9 MT, 6.4 MT sourced from commercial mines and 47.7 MT through captive sources).

In FY25, NTPC's coal demand was 280 MT, of which 44.9 MT was met through captive sources, 11.6 MT from commercial mines and imports, and 226.7 MT from CIL and SCCL.

With over 90 GW installed capacity, NTPC is among the leading buyers of coal from Coal India Ltd. It sources the fuel under long-term fuel supply agreements (FSAs) with the coal behemoth.

NTPC has reported about 13 per cent year-on-year growth in power generation to 117.9 billion units (BUs) in July-September from 104.4 BUs in the year-ago quarter.

As per official data, as of October 5, as many as 90 plants are facing a critical coal stock situation out of 191 plants having a total capacity of about 225 GW.

The plants have coal stock of 20.58 MT against 61.17 MT, data showed.

A plant falls under the critical category if its coal stock is less than 25 per cent of the usual quantity. The daily coal stock requirement is calculated at 85 per cent of the plant load factor (PLF) or capacity utilisation.

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY | OCTOBER 7, 2026



No longer a niche:

Why IPR should be a core subject in law schools

IPR is increasingly central to technology, creative industries and business. Yet it remains largely an elective in law schools. Making it a core subject, supported by practical learning and internships, can better prepare future lawyers for the knowledge economy



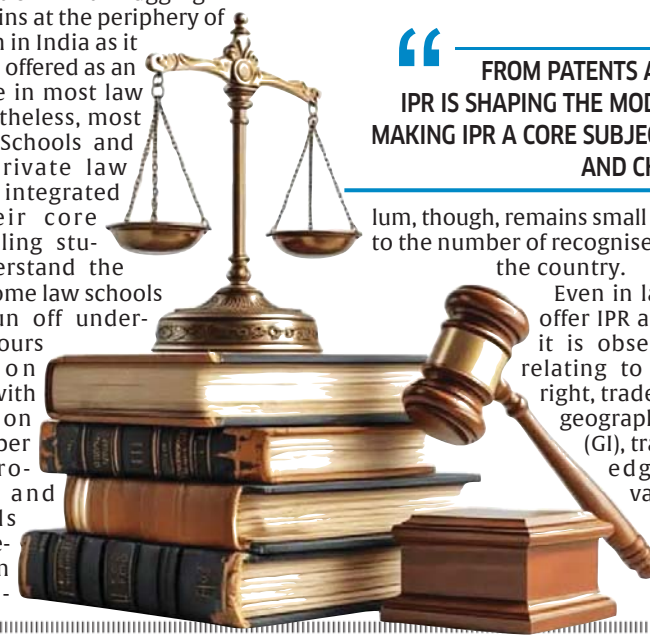
VISHWAS H DEVAIAH
Dean, BITS Law School

The world around us has changed significantly over the last two decades. Innovations that go beyond any single sector have deeply influenced how business is conducted across the world. Innovations like the internet, mobile phones and smartphones have clearly enabled multiple players to see business opportunities that have resulted in a plurality of commercial apps and platforms through which trillions of dollars' worth of business are being done. The Bharat Deep Tech Report 2026 identifies that nearly USD 11.4 billion worth of private equity investments have been made in Indian deep tech startups between 2015-2026. At the core of such innovation lies an intangible asset known in common parlance as a patent, which is a privilege granted by states to incentivise innovators to openly disclose innovations in exchange for a brief period of monopoly. It is also relevant to note that nearly 140,000 patent applications were filed between April 2025-March 2026. This surge also points to the fact that many entities, including startups, have become more aware of the commercial potential of their innovations and of the need to safeguard their innovations from rivals.

Copyright has enabled and encouraged the creative industry to earn through music, books, motion pictures, reels, photos and many other creative forms. Business entities and celebrities have also found ways and means of popularising their brands through logos and trademarks. Design patents for the aesthetic value of a product and semiconductor protection for chips have enabled corporate entities to protect their investments from cheap counterfeits and rivals.

Intellectual property laws that protect intangible assets have become more significant in the last two decades. Globalisation and uniform trade norms like the Agreement on Trade-Related Aspects of Intellectual Property Rights (TRIPS Agreement) brought about the harmonisation of minimum standards of protection of intellectual property rights across the world.

IPR norms play a significant role in the technology and creative sectors and have been the key engine that's driven deep-tech innovation and the growth of creative content in India. However, the emphasis on the IPR curriculum in legal education is still lagging in India. IPR remains at the periphery of legal education in India as it continues to be offered as an elective course in most law schools. Nevertheless, most National Law Schools and some elite private law schools have integrated IPR into their core courses, enabling students to understand the basics of IPR. Some law schools have also spun off undergraduate Honours Specialisation Programmes with an emphasis on IPR. The number of such programmes and law schools that have integrated IPR in their curriculum, though, remains small when compared to the number of recognised law schools in the country.



> FROM PATENTS AND TRADEMARKS TO COPYRIGHT AND DEEP-TECH INNOVATION, IPR IS SHAPING THE MODERN ECONOMY. YET LEGAL EDUCATION HAS NOT KEPT PACE. MAKING IPR A CORE SUBJECT CAN PREPARE STUDENTS FOR THE GROWING OPPORTUNITIES AND CHALLENGES OF THE KNOWLEDGE ECONOMY

Even in law schools that offer IPR as a core course, it is observed that laws relating to patents, copyright, trademarks, designs, geographical indications (GI), traditional knowledge and plant variety protection are taught in a hurried manner as a single course without a solid theoretical foundation. Each of these intangible property rights has its own nuances, and a lack of deeper engagement with these IP rights leaves students with a superficial understanding of IPR. Deeper engagement with the various aspects of IPR in the form of multiple courses, along with meaningful internship opportunities, will enable students to gain a strong foundation in IPR along with practical insight into how it works. Given that today's lawyers are living in the age of the knowledge economy and will have to deal with disputes in this field, it is important to ensure that IPR is taught as a core subject that can enable students to have a basic understanding of IPR with some practical insights.

Think beyond the traditional MBA career

SHENBAGARAMAN VM
Dean, Faculty of Management, SRMIST

The paths that an MBA degree most commonly leads to are consulting, banking or general management. Management education equips people with a particular way of thinking, including how to allocate resources, how to negotiate across competing interests, how to read a system and improve it and more. This way of thinking is useful in diverse arenas. Yet most of the new-age management careers are scarcely discussed, overshadowed by a handful of familiar, well-worn paths.

Revenue and pricing strategy

Few functions demand as unusual a mix of mathematics and psychology as pricing. The price of an airline seat can change before the flight departs. So can the price of a hotel room or a warehouse of inventory on an e-commerce site. Someone orchestrates these changes, often within minutes, using a combination of demand forecasts, competitor prices and an educated guess about consumer behaviour. Airlines, hospitality chains and ride-hailing platforms now run entire teams built for this single question. This career draws heavily on statistics and consumer-behaviour theory that most MBA students have already studied.

Sustainability and ESG strategy

As environmental governance reporting has moved from a compliance footnote to a priority, a new kind of role has emerged: professionals who build and oversee an organisation's entire ESG strategy, including setting emissions targets, designing responsible sourcing policies, tracking governance standards across supply chains and preparing the necessary disclosures. The work involves long-term strategic thinking. It is a modern career track, barely a decade old in its current form, and one built on a kind of systems thinking that most management programmes teach.



Commercial and regulatory strategy

Another interesting career option sits at the intersection of management and law. Management graduates are being hired for roles focused on regulatory strategy and compliance risk. Large corporations like pharmaceutical companies, fintech companies, telecom companies and others need someone who can read a regulatory change and translate it into a business decision. This work has quietly become a management function. The people doing it are expected to judge whether a product, a partnership, or a market is worth the compliance risk it carries. It is a career built on reading fine print for its commercial consequences rather than its legal ones.

A wider landscape

Beyond these, management graduates have carved out careers in equally unexpected niches: insurance product design, disaster and humanitarian logistics, talent and royalty management in the music industry and behavioural research for public policy think tanks. Each of these draws on the same core management toolkit, applied somewhere few graduates think to look.

A career question

What unites these roles is the fact that each demands the same underlying capabilities: negotiation, resource allocation under constraint and functioning across teams. Management education builds exactly this kind of thinking that is relevant far beyond the handful of careers students typically picture for themselves. The more students look beyond the obvious paths, the more clearly they'll see just how wide the field of management really is.



> MANAGEMENT GRADUATES ARE BEING HIRED FOR ROLES FOCUSED ON REGULATORY STRATEGY AND COMPLIANCE RISK. LARGE CORPORATIONS LIKE PHARMACEUTICAL COMPANIES, FINTECH COMPANIES, TELECOM COMPANIES AND OTHERS NEED SOMEONE WHO CAN READ A REGULATORY CHANGE AND TRANSLATE IT INTO A BUSINESS DECISION

Why design thinking is the career skill of the future

Design thinking helps students build adaptable skills for creative, evolving careers in a technology-driven world

TANYA GUPTA
HOD, Associate Professor,
IMS DIA, Noida

Ask a Class 12 student what a designer does, and you will probably hear "sketches, fabrics, software". Ask an employer, and the answer changes: someone who understands people, finds the real problem and builds something that works. Design thinking sits in the gap between those two answers.

At its core, design thinking is a way of solving problems by starting with people. It moves through empathising with users, defining the actual problem, generating ideas, prototyping and testing. What it really builds is a habit: asking "who is this for, and why does it matter?" before asking "how should it look?"

Parents often wonder whether design is a secure choice. Consider where hiring is heading. Employers increasingly look for user research, product thinking, accessibility and service design, which are roles where judgement counts for more than tools. AI can now produce layouts and visuals in seconds. What it cannot replace is understanding context, culture and consequence.

This is where a programme's approach matters. Conventional courses often teach design as a series of subjects, tested through exams. At IMS DIA, established in 2005, learning is studio-led and project-driven, with a strong emphasis on practical training. Students work on live industry briefs, learn from practising professionals and build portfolios that show how they think, not just what they make. Programmes across fashion, interior, communication, product and jewellery design, along with international collaborations such as Mod'Art International Paris, widen their outlook early.

> THE SKILLS THAT TRAVEL WITH YOU BEYOND THE CLASSROOM ARE RESEARCH, PROTOTYPING, VISUAL STORYTELLING, COLLABORATION, CLIENT COMMUNICATION, AND THE CONFIDENCE TO NAVIGATE UNCERTAINTY AND EMBRACE NEW POSSIBILITIES

In practice, a communication design student does not simply design an app screen. She interviews commuters, maps their experiences, tests prototypes and, as per the feedback, revises the design. An interior design student enquires how a compact home can work for a family of five before choosing a colour palette. A product design student weighs material, cost and sustainability from the first sketch. Each project teaches the same lesson: the first idea is rarely the best one, and feedback is a tool, not a threat.



The skills that travel with you beyond the classroom are research, prototyping, visual storytelling, collaboration, client communication, and the confidence to navigate uncertainty and embrace new possibilities. They lead to careers such as UX designer, design researcher, service designer, sustainable product designer, brand strategist or entrepreneur. Many of these roles barely existed a decade ago.

Above all, design thinking builds adaptability. Industries will keep shifting and tools will keep changing. A student trained to question, test and iterate can learn the next platform. A person trained only in today's software may struggle when the tools evolve. But strong design fundamentals, problem-solving, and adaptability remain relevant, helping designers learn, unlearn, and adapt to new technologies.

Two practical suggestions: Students should build portfolios that showcase the entire design process, including research, experimentation, iterations, and failed attempts, not just polished outcomes. Parents, meanwhile, should ask institutions how much learning happens through live projects, industry exposure, and hands-on experiences, and what kind of mentoring and guidance students receive throughout the journey.

Because the careers of the future will be shaped not by what students can produce, but by how well they can think, adapt, and solve problems.

Educating for what lies ahead

ADITYA CHOWGULE
President, Chowgule
Education Society

Education has always been a bridge, from a stage of acquiring knowledge to a stage of adult responsibility and active participation in society. That purpose hasn't changed. What has changed is the pace at which the world on the other side of that bridge keeps shifting. Technology has compressed the time from innovation to disruption. Artificial intelligence, automation and digitalisation are transforming industries faster than traditional cycles of education can keep up. The World Economic Forum's Future of Jobs Report 2025 states that 39 per cent of the current skill sets of workers may be disrupted or become redundant by 2030. AI and big data are among the fastest-growing skills, but so are creative thinking, resilience, flexibility, agility and lifelong learning.

This places a different kind of responsibility on education. The question is no longer only which jobs students should be prepared for by 2035. It is also how the tasks within those jobs will evolve, and whether students will have the ability to adapt as they do. Uncertainty is increasingly less an irregular interruption and more a defining feature of professional life. That is why employment cannot be an outcome at the end of education. It has to be built throughout the educational process.



> THE WORLD ECONOMIC FORUM'S FUTURE OF JOBS REPORT 2025 STATES THAT 39 PER CENT OF THE CURRENT SKILL SETS OF WORKERS MAY BE DISRUPTED OR BECOME REDUNDANT BY 2030

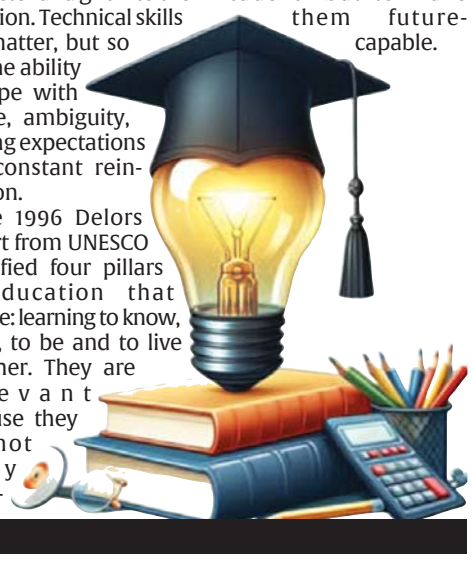
Students need strong disciplinary knowledge, but also the ability to question, interpret, collaborate, solve unfamiliar problems and learn on a continuous basis. Education should equip them with the confidence to navigate situations that may not come with a playbook.

This transition becomes more crucial with AI. Education should not respond to AI by adding another technology module to the curriculum. Students need to learn how to work with intelligent systems while developing the human capabilities that will remain essential as work evolves: judgement, curiosity, empathy, ethical reasoning, creativity and critical thinking. And just as important, they need the confidence to keep learning when the skills they learn today aren't worth as much tomorrow.

That also puts resilience, character and grit into the equation. Technical skills will matter, but so will the ability to cope with failure, ambiguity, shifting expectations and constant reinvention.

The 1996 Delors Report from UNESCO identified four pillars of education that endure: learning to know, to do, to be and to live together. They are relevant because they are not only oriented towards immediate occupational skills, but towards the development of the individual. Therefore, for educational institutions, the challenge is greater than curriculum revision. It takes leadership that builds cultures of adaptability, experimentation and lifelong learning in teachers and exposes students to real-world complexity long before they join the workforce.

Education can't promise students will know their careers in 2035. But it can give them something more lasting: the knowledge, character and agency to manage uncertainty, collaborate with technology and keep evolving with the world around them. The goal is not to future-proof students but to make them future-capable.



Pak, Turkiye agree to deploy forces in Saudi

SAJJAD HUSSAIN ■ Islamabad



Pakistan and Turkiye have agreed to deploy their military forces in Saudi Arabia under a recently concluded pact between the three countries.

The decision comes in the wake of attacks by Iran-backed Houthi rebels of Yemen in the Gulf country.

The three sides had convened an emergency meeting of the Strategic Political and Defence Committee (SPDC) of the Makkah Alliance for Defence in Riyadh on Monday to address the regional developments and threats facing Saudi Arabia, according to a joint statement.

The defence agreement, signed by Pakistan, Saudi Arabia and Turkiye in August, establishes a framework for collective deterrence and stipulates that an armed attack against any one of them would be regarded as an attack against all. The SPDC reviewed the outcomes of the political and military consultations preceding the meeting and approved the recommendations submitted to it. It affirmed that the Makkah agreement embodies a firm commitment to collective defence and a unified position in confronting threats. The committee "decided to move immediately to the practical implementation of the collective defence commitments and to take the necessary measures to provide the agreed military forces and capabilities and ensure their rapid deployment in the Kingdom"."The three countries affirmed that the security of each party is an integral part of the collective security of the three countries," the statement said.

The statement did not give any details or schedule of troop deployment. It also did not specifically name the Houthis as a threat, but the development comes against the backdrop of Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia.

Deputy Prime Minister Ishaq Dar, Defence Minister Khawaja Asif, and Chief of Army Staff Field Marshal Asim Munir attended the meeting from Pakistan's side. Khawaja Asif, in an interview to Geo News, said that Pakistan and Turkiye had a "presence in theatre", but only Saudi troops were involved in combat operations. "Whatever assistance they require is being provided. But right now, the Turkish and Pakistani armies are playing a supportive role," he said, noting that Pakistan was involved in reconnaissance.

The three sides also condemned in the strongest terms the attempted targeting of Makkah and Madinah, as well as the continuing attacks targeting cities and civilian and economic facilities in Saudi Arabia. Pakistan and Turkiye commended the vigilance and readiness of the Saudi Armed Forces in countering the threats and attacks facing the Kingdom, the statement said. (*PTI*)

Hindu temple vandalised in Pakistan's Sindh; man arrested

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Karachi



A man has been arrested on suspicion of vandalising a Hindu temple in Rathi village in the Nagarparkar area of Pakistan, police said on Tuesday. The man was taken into custody after parts of the Mata Jog Maya Temple were found vandalised on Monday night, a local police officer said.

"When the caretaker woke up this morning, he found some of the murtis (idols) smashed and broken and reported the matter to the police," said Shiva Kaachi, chairman of the Pakistan Darawar Ittehad NGO.

Kaachi said police had taken a man into custody as the prime suspect in the incident. However, no further details about the accused were immediately available.

"It is a small temple, but since Nagarparkar has a large concentration of Hindu community, it is common for every village to have a small temple for Hindus to worship and pray," Kaachi said.

The police officer said an investigation was underway to determine whether more than one person was involved. He confirmed that parts of the place of worship had been vandalised.

Russia claims 900 Ukrainian drones downed

ASSOCIATED PRESS ■ Kyiv



Russian air defences intercepted nearly 900 Ukrainian drones overnight over multiple regions of the country, as well as the occupied Crimean Peninsula and the Sea of Azov, the Defence Ministry in Moscow said on Tuesday.

Unconfirmed media reports said a major fuel depot in the Moscow region was on fire after the attack that killed two people.

Ukraine's domestically developed long-range drones and, increasingly, missiles have allowed Kyiv to hit Russian soil during the more than 4.5 years since Moscow's forces launched a full-scale invasion. It has hit targets as far east as the Urals and Siberia.

The bigger Russian military's air superiority during the war has made aerial attacks on civilian areas of Ukraine routine. Ukrainian officials are now bracing for what President Volodymyr Zelenskyy warned Tuesday is an upcoming "massive" aerial attack by Russia.

"Today, we received updated intelligence on Russia's preparations for a massive strike. We are preparing countermeasures," Zelenskyy said on social media. "We set deadlines for a significant part of the tasks, and the highest-priority ones are already being implemented."

UK Police arrest 7th man in connection with security incident at US-run airbase

JILL LAWLESS ■ London



British police on Tuesday arrested a 22-year-old man in London on suspicion of a terror offense over a security incident at a US-run military airbase in England that authorities have linked to Iran.

The arrest is the seventh in connection with a suspected plot against RAF Fairford, located 160 kilometres west of London, which has been used by American bombers to strike Iran during this year's war.

Counter Terrorism Policing said the man, a British national, was detained in the Westminster area of central London on suspicion of preparation of terrorist acts. Six other men have been released on bail under investigation.

Vicki Evans, the senior national coordinator for counterterrorism policing said detectives "continue to pursue multiple lines of enquiry" and "remain committed to investigating all possible angles."Scores of residents were evacuated from their homes near the base early on September 27 as armed police officers and army bomb-disposal experts swooped on the rural area. Police later said they had found a quantity of an accelerant — gasoline — in three vans linked to the five suspects, but no explosives.

Prime Minister Andy Burnham has said the UK sees "strong indications" that Iran played a part in the incident, without saying why or what the nature of the suspected plot was. Iran has denied involvement, but it has previously said it considers any base used to attack its territory a legitimate target. The US moved its B-52 and B-1 bombers from RAF Fairford on Sunday, though it's unclear whether the move is connected to the arrests. (*AP*)

Lighthouse Learning ties up with Clifton College



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

Lighthouse Learning has announced a partnership with UK-based Clifton College, a 164-year-old independent educational institution, marking Clifton College's first international presence outside the United Kingdom.

The partnership aims to bring global educational practices, international exposure and new learning opportunities to students in India. It will combine Lighthouse Learning's education expertise and scale in India with Clifton College's long-standing academic heritage and international outlook.

The two institutions will collaborate on knowledge exchange, global exposure and new approaches to preparing young people for a rapidly changing world. Key areas of focus will include leadership, entrepreneurship, cultural understanding, adaptability and independent thinking. Prajodh Rajan, Founder and Group CEO of Lighthouse Learning Group, said the partnership aligns with the organisation's mission to make high-quality educational thinking and practices from around the world accessible to children in India. "Our mission is to ignite the love for learning in one million children. We believe children in India should have access to the best educational thinking and practices from around the world," Rajan said.

He added that the collaboration would bring together elements of the Indian and British education systems to create new learning experiences for students.

Dr Christopher Stevens, Executive Head of Clifton College Education Group, said the institution's entry into India reflected its ambition and its belief in the country's growing importance as a destination for global education.

He said India's young population and increasing engagement with international education presented opportunities for collaboration and learning.The partnership will also allow Clifton College to bring its educational approach to a new context while learning from India's diverse education ecosystem.

The collaboration marks a new chapter for both institutions, with Lighthouse Learning expanding its international education partnerships and Clifton College establishing its first presence beyond the UK.

Kenya confirms first Ebola case after traveller from Congo dies in Nairobi

EVELYNE MUSAMBI ■ Nairobi



Kenyan authorities on Tuesday confirmed the country's first imported Ebola case from Congo, making Kenya the latest country affected by the fast-moving outbreak.

Health Minister Aden Duale said a Kenyan citizen who arrived in the country on Saturday from Congo via its neighbour Uganda had been isolated and treated at Nairobi Hospital, where he tested positive for the Ebola virus and died late on Monday.

Ebola is highly contagious and spreads in the human population through contact with bodily fluids such as vomit, blood or semen, and with contaminated surfaces and materials such as bedding and clothing. The current outbreak was declared in mid-May, months after it had been spreading in a remote part of eastern Congo. At least 8,400 cases have been recorded, including over 4,000 deaths, according to government data, making it the fastest-growing outbreak of the disease in history.

Kenya had never had an outbreak of Ebola, according to the Kenya Medical Research Institute.

The country hosts a United States-funded isolation centre for American citizens exposed to Ebola to quarantine for 21 days before travelling back to the US. The isolation facility faced legal battles and deadly protests by locals who feared it was exposing them to the virus. (*AP*)

STATE BANK OF INDIA,
Branch Office: Home Loan Centre East Delhi (15811), Unity One Mall, First Floor, CBD, Shahdara, Delhi-110032

PUBLIC NOTICE-LOST DOCUMENT

STATE BANK OF INDIA, Home Loan Centre East Delhi (15811), hereby informs the general public that **the following original document has been lost/misplaced and could not be traced despite best efforts:-**

Builder - Buyer Agreement dated 23.03.2013, executed between **M/s Amrapali Valley Private Limited and (1) Ms. Ashu Malhotra, D/o Sh. Vinod Malhotra and (2) Sh. Vinod Kumar Malhotra S/o Sh. Fateh Chand Malhotra.**

The aforesaid original document has not been traceable since 23.09.2026. The document is required by the customer and the builder at the time of possession of unit offered by the builder "and thereafter at the time of subsequent sale of the unit, if any". An Information Report bearing LR No.658254/2026 dated 24.09.2026 has also been lodged with **Delhi Police.**

Any person having any information regarding the said original document or having possession of the same is requested to contact the undersigned at the address given below immediately.

Date: 06/10/2026
Place: Delhi

(Branch Head, State Bank of India)
Home Loan Centre East Delhi (15811) 1st Floor, Unity One Mall CBD Shahdara, New Delhi-110032

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Central Bank of India
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Regional Office Delhi (North)
1398, First Floor, Chandni Chowk, Delhi-110006

E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE
(Under SARFAESI Act 2002)

APPENDIX- IV-A [SEE PROVISO TO RULE 8(6) & 9(1) SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTIES

E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) & 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the borrower(s) and guarantor(s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged / charged to the Central Bank of India (secured creditor), the constructive/ physical Possession of which have been taken by the authorized officer of Central Bank of India(Secured creditors), **will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on date 23.10.2026** for recovery of dues to the **Central Bank of India** from below mention Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s). The Reserve Price and Earnest money deposit (EMD) is displayed against the details of respective properties.

E-AUCTION SCHEDULED TO BE HELD ON 23.10.2026 (15 DAY'S NOTICE)

In Rupees

S. No.	Name of Branch	Authorised Officer / B.M.	Name of the Account / Property ID on E-Baanknet Portal	Description of Property & Owner Name	Demand Notice Date & Amount Dues (in Rupees)	Date & Type of Possession	Reserve Price / EMD / Bid Increase
1.	Daryaganj New Delhi	Mr. Swati Kumari Mobile: 7428926731	Amit Kumar / CBIN029005	Flat No-301, 2nd Floor, Front Side, MIG, Deep Apartments-VI, Plot No. A-4/18, DLF Ankur Vihar, Loni, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201102 Area 750 Sq Ft. **Owner: Amit Kumar**	10.04.2019 Rs.12.59 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deductions/ Repayments	04.06.2022 (Physical)	₹ 12,50,000.00 / ₹ 1,25,000.00 / ₹ 10,000.00
2.	Ghonda Delhi	Mr. Arvind Kumar Mobile: 9999917130	Prem Pal Bhardwaj / CBIN127806	All Part and Parcel of Built Property, Constructed of Whatsoever on Property No. X-16, Land Area Measuring 100 Sq.Yds Out of Khasra No.142/2, X Block Vill- Ghonda, Street No.2, Gujran Banger , Abadi Brahampuri, Ilaqa Shahdra Delhi. Area 100 Sq Yd **Owner: Prem Pal Bhardwaj**	30.08.2024 Rs.151.12 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deductions/ Repayments	23.04.2025 (Physical)	₹ 1,13,50,000.00 / ₹ 11,35,000.00 / ₹ 50,000.00
3.	LRPG College Ghaziabad	Ms. Ekta Kapoor Mobile: 8800013520	Kumar Gaurav / CBIN331406	Flat No FF-4, First Floor, Without Roof Rights Right Hand Back Side S.L.F. Ved Vihar , Plot No E-16,Village Sadullabad,Pargana,Tehsil Loni District Ghaziabad(Up) 201002 . Area - 37.16 Sq Mtr **Owner: Kumar Gaurav**	30.01.2025 Rs.13.71 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deductions/ Repayments	13.03.2026 (Physical)	₹ 10,80,000.00 / ₹ 1,08,000.00 / ₹ 10,000.00
4.	Sehani Ghaziabad	Mr Abhay Mishra Mobile: 8588907378	Udaivir Singh / CBIN026208	1st and 2nd Floor, Residential Flat On Plot No. A-68, Khasra No. 389, Village-Ghonda Gurjan Khadar, Bhajanpura, Shahdara, New Delhi-110053. Area:611.83 Sqft **Owner: Udaivir Singh**	11.05.2021 Rs.11.89 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deductions/ Repayments	21.03.2025 (Physical)	₹ 16,10,000.00 / ₹ 1,61,000.00 / ₹ 10,000.00
5.	Vasundhara Ghaziabad	Mr. Anand Jaiswal Mobile: 8800013545	Pushpender Kumar / CBIN497202	Second Floor Flat, SF-4, Four Story Building, Plot No.B-5/1, DLF Ankur Vihar, Near Shiv Vatika Temple Loni Ghaziabad. Area 37.16 Sq mtr **Owner: Pushpender Kumar**	09.07.2018 Rs.14.09 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deductions/ Repayments	28.10.2020 (Physical)	₹ 7,30,000.00 / ₹ 73,000.00 / ₹ 5,000.00
6.	Patparganj Delhi	Mr Mohit Gangwar Mobile: 8171783511	Juneja Trading Co Prop Ms. Rajni Juneja Mrs Ramesh Rani Juneja / CBIN166902	Shop No 3097/03, Part of Property Bearing Municipal No 1502 (Old) and 3097 (New), Ground Floor Situated at Ward No VI, Mohalla Dessan Peepal Mahadev, Hauz Qazi Delhi- 110006. Area : 83 Sqft **Owner : Ramesh Rani Juneja**	17.10.2025 Rs.11.32 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deductions/ Repayments	12.06.2026 (Physical)	₹ 11,00,000.00 / ₹ 1,10,000.00 / ₹ 10,000.00
7.	Vasundhara Ghaziabad	Mr. Anand Jaiswal Mobile: 8800013545	Shiv Singh / CBIN497204	Flat No SF-2,Second Floor (With Roof Rights), Front Side, MIG, Plot No A-7/6, DLF Ankur Vihar, Loni Ghaziabad, Area:55.74 Sqmt **Owner: Shiv Singh**	04.02.2025 Rs.33.63 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deduction/ Repayments	16.01.2026 (Physical)	₹ 15,30,000.00 / ₹ 1,53,000.00 / ₹ 10,000.00
8.	Patel Nagar Ghaziabad	Mr. Vinod Meena Mobile: 9694707646	Soniya / CBIN402508	Residential Flat No. Nyaykhand-3/487, E.W.S Ground Floor Without Roof Rights, Indirapuram Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh Area-24.65 Sq Mtr **Owner- Ms. Soniya W/o Vikram Singh**	01.03.2025 Rs.9.67 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deduction/ Repayments	05.12.2025 (Physical)	₹ 9,90,000.00 / ₹ 99,000.00 / ₹ 5,000.00
9.	Ushmanpur Delhi	Mr Hussain Ali Mobile: 9568431985	Ajay Kumar Mishra / CBIN352402	Flat No. FF-3, LIG, First Floor, Front Side, Plot No. A-27, Ganga Vihar, Hadbast Gram Sadullahbad, Pargana - Loni, Tehsil And Distt- Ghaziabad, Up, Area: 37.16 Sqmt **Owner: Ajay Kumar Mishra**	13.09.2023 Rs.8.57 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deduction/ Repayments	18.01.2025 (Physical)	₹ 8,80,000.00 / ₹ 88,000.00 / ₹ 10,000.00
10.	Ushmanpur Delhi	Mr Hussain Ali Mobile: 9568431985	Sudha Bhaskar / CBIN352405	Property Bearing Flat No F-5, First Floor, LIG Back Side without roof, Block B-01, Plot No. B- 1/151, DLF Dilshad Extn - 2, Shahibabad, Ghaziabad (U.P) Measuring - 450 Sq.Ft. **Owner : Sudha Bhaskar**	21.05.2021 Rs.12.53 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deduction/ Repayments	09.04.2025 (Physical)	₹ 11,85,000.00 / ₹ 1,18,500.00 / ₹ 10,000.00
11.	SDS School Delhi	Mr Bhawesh Kumar Mobile: 8521795402	Shree Agencies / CBIN3323002	Property Bearing No.1/11218-A,Second Floor (Right Side Portion), Gali No. 13 Subhash Park Shahdara Delhi 110032. Area -405 Sq ft **Owner- Smt. Deepa Bhardwaj W/o Shri Vikas Bhardwaj.**	20.10.2023 Rs.58.70 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deduction/ Repayments	10.06.2025 (Physical)	₹ 14,25,000.00 / ₹ 1,42,500.00 / ₹ 15,000.00
12.	SDS School Delhi	Mr Bhawesh Kumar Mobile: 8521795402	Shree Agencies / CBIN3323001	Entire Ground Floor without (Roof Rights Built up on Property Bearing No.29 Khasra No.430. Situated at Village Maujpur in the abadi of Bhagat Singh Gali West Babar Pur, Shahdara, Delhi -110032. Area-360 Sq ft **Owner- Smt. Deepa Bhardwaj W/o Shri Vikas Bhardwaj.**	20.10.2023 Rs.58.70 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deduction/ Repayments	10.06.2025 (Physical)	₹ 14,00,000.00 / ₹ 1,40,000.00 / ₹ 15,000.00

E-AUCTION DATE: 23.10.2026, TIME: 12:00 NOON TO 04:00 PM WITH AUTO EXTENSION OF 10 MINUTES

Last Date & Time of Submission of EMD and Documents (Online) On or Before: 23.10.2026 Upto 03:30 PM.

Bidder will register on website: **https://BAANKNET.com** and upload KYC documents and after verification of KYC documents by the service provider, EMD to be deposited in **BAANKNET** EMD wallet through NEFT/RTGS/Transfer / Generation of challan from (**https://BAANKNET.com**). The auction will be conducted through common landing platform BAANKNET.com Portal (**https://BAANKNET.com**). E-auction will be held "As is where is", "As is what is" and "whatever is there is" basis. **(All other charges/dues to the property will be borne by the purchaser).**

For detailed terms and conditions please refer to the link provided in **www.centralbank.bank.in** Secured Creditor or auction platform (**https://BAANKNET.com**). **Helpdesk: (+91) 8291220220, E-mail: support.BAANKNET@psballiance.com**

STATUTORY 15 DAY'S SALE NOTICE UNDER RULE 8(6) & 9(1) OF THE SARFAESI ACT, 2002

Borrowers/Guarantors/ Mortgagors are hereby notified to pay the sum as mentioned above along with upto date interest and ancillary expenses before the date of e-auction, failing which the property will be auctioned/sold and balance dues, if any, will be recovered with interest and cost.

DATE: 06.10.2026
PLACE: DELHI

Authorised Officer,
CENTRAL BANK OF INDIA, RO Delhi (North), Delhi

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY | OCTOBER 7, 2026

I've done my duty: Harmanpreet steps down from India women's team captaincy



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ New Delhi

India's only World Cup-winning women's cricket captain Harmanpreet Kaur on Tuesday stepped down from her position in all three formats, saying that she has done her duty as leader and is now "ready to play for the love of the game again."

The 37-year-old's announcement came after a BCCI review meeting in Guwahati to evaluate the team's trajectory in the past few months. Chaired by BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia, the meeting was attended by Harmanpreet, vice-captain Smriti Mandhana and head coach Amol Muzumdar.

Mandhana, who has recently been vocal about her ambitions to lead the 'Women in Blue', is the front-runner to take over as the next captain.

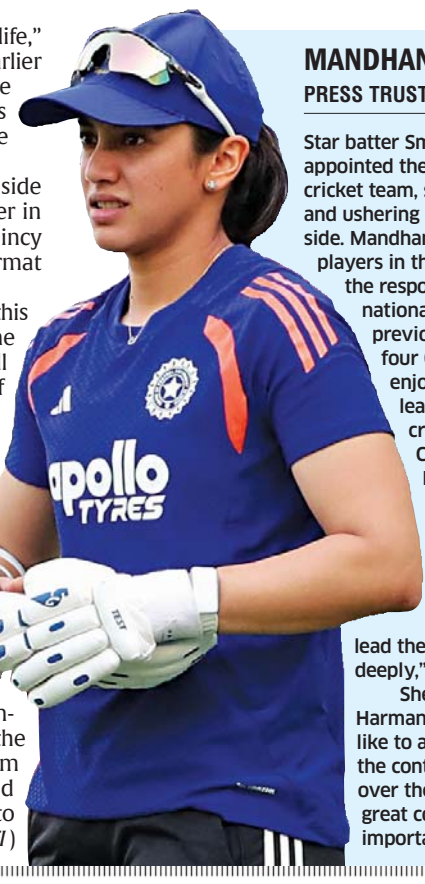
"Today, I step down as captain of the Indian Women's Cricket Team across all formats," Harmanpreet, who has been enduring a lean patch for a while now, wrote in an Instagram post. "This is not an easy decision. It carries years of memories, emotions, sacrifices, and moments that will stay with me for the rest of my life," added the right-hander, who had earlier spoken about wanting to lead the team till at least the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics for which India have already qualified.

Harmanpreet led the Indian T20 side for a decade, taking over as skipper in 2016. She was elevated to ODI captaincy in 2022 before becoming the all-format leader in 2023.

"I feel I have done my duty. I gave this team everything I had. I carried the responsibility with pride, and I will always be grateful for the privilege of leading Indian women's cricket," said the player who hails from Moga in Punjab.

She will, however, continue to play for India across formats.

"Now, it is time for me to turn the page. Captaincy may end today, but my love for Indian cricket never will. Blood. Sweat. Sacrifice. Pride. I gave it all. Now, I'm ready to play for the love of the game again. Captaincy ends. The journey continues," she said. In her statement, the veteran batter said she gave the team everything she had as its captain and often put aside her personal goals to fulfill her duties. (*PTI*)



MANDHANA APPOINTED CAPTAIN

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ New Delhi

Star batter Smriti Mandhana was on Tuesday appointed the captain of the Indian women's cricket team, succeeding Harmanpreet Kaur and ushering in a new leadership era for the side. Mandhana, one of the most experienced players in the Indian team, has been handed the responsibility after being part of the national setup since 2013. She has previously led India in 18 T20Is and four ODIs. The 29-year-old has also enjoyed considerable success as a leader in domestic and franchise cricket, most notably guiding Royal Challengers Bengaluru to Women's Premier League titles in 2024 and 2026. "Being given the responsibility of leading India is a very special honour. Representing India has always meant a great deal to me, and to now have the opportunity to lead the team is something I will value deeply," Mandhana said.

She also acknowledged Harmanpreet's contribution. "I would also like to acknowledge Harmanpreet and the contribution she has made as captain over the years. She has led the team with great commitment and has been an important part of our journey," she said.

Harmanpreet's contribution will hold special place: BCCI



BCCI president Mithun Manhas FILE PHOTO

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ New Delhi

The 2025 Women's World Cup triumph will remain the defining achievement of Harmanpreet Kaur's captaincy and ensure that her contribution to Indian cricket occupies a "special place" in its history, the BCCI said on Tuesday after the veteran batter stepped down as the national team's leader across formats. BCCI president Mithun Manhas hailed Harmanpreet's leadership through a significant phase in the growth of women's cricket in the country, while expressing satisfaction that the 37-year-old will continue to represent India as a player.

"Harmanpreet Kaur's contribution as captain will always hold a special place in the history of Indian cricket," Manhas said in a statement issued by the BCCI.

"The World Cup victory in 2025 will undoubtedly be the defining achievement of her captaincy. It was the culmination of years of progress, hard work and belief. Her Asian Games gold medals and the many important victories during her tenure further underline the contribution she has made."

Harmanpreet, who took over India's T20I captaincy in 2016 before becoming the full-time ODI and Test skipper in 2022, ended her leadership stint after guiding the team to its maiden Women's World Cup title last year and a second successive Asian Games gold in Nagoya, Japan last month.

In her communication to the BCCI, Harmanpreet said she believed it was the right time to hand over the captaincy but made it clear that her commitment to Indian cricket remained undiminished.

"Leading India has been one of the greatest honours and privileges of my life," she said. "After careful consideration, I believe that this is the right time for me to hand over the responsibility of captaincy and allow the team to move forward under new leadership." The former captain also stressed that she wanted to continue playing for India and contribute to team in a different capacity.

"However, my commitment to Indian cricket remains as strong as ever. I would like to continue representing the Indian Women's Cricket Team as a player and contribute to the team's success in every way I can," she said.

Iyer hits maiden T20I ton, Dhir takes 3 on debut as India thrash WI by 8 wickets

SAUMOJYOTI S CHOUDHURY ■ Lucknow

Skipper Shreyas Iyer led from the front with a maiden T20I century after all-rounder Naman Dhir made a dream debut with three wickets as India comfortably defeated West Indies by eight wickets in the first match here on Tuesday.

Dhir picked up three wickets with his off-spin to finish with impressive figures of 3/31, while Kuldeep Yadav took 2/33 as India, after opting to bowl, restricted West Indies to 171.

Iyer (102 not out) and Ishan Kishan (37 not out) then made short work of the chase, stitching together an unbeaten 137-run partnership for the third wicket to help India chase down the target in 14.4 overs.

Chasing the total, India didn't have the best of starts as they lost both openers Abhishek Sharma (21) and Sanju Samson (11) inside four overs with the scoreboard reading 35.

Roston Chase picked up Abhishek in the third over, with Shimron Hetmyer taking a brilliant diving catch while running in from long-off. An over later, Sanju Samson departed, extending his lean patch since the Asian Games, as he sliced a short delivery back to Akeal Hosein, who took the catch off his own bowling.

Thereafter, skipper Shreyas Iyer and Ishan Kishan stabilised the innings with a 137-run partnership. Iyer, in particular, looked ominous, smashing boundaries all around the ground and taking the initiative to guide the chase.

With his captain in great touch, Ishan played second fiddle as India remained in command, reaching 102 for two at the halfway mark.

Iyer was elegant with his strokeplay, finding the boundaries with classical shots, including a straight six over long-off off pacer Shamar Springer in the 11th over. The Mumbaikar remained in ominous touch and made the chase a cakewalk, smashing Hosein over long-off for a maximum before hitting the left-arm spinner through the same region for a boundary off the next ball. Iyer then went hammer and tongs, finding fours and sixes at will to bring up his century off 42 balls with a six over long-on off Chase.



India's captain Shreyas Iyer celebrates his century with Ishan Kishan during the first T20I cricket match of a series between India and West Indies in Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh on Tuesday PTI

Earlier, sent into bat, West Indies skipper Shai Hope started the innings in a flurry, smacking Mayank Yadav for four boundaries in the second over to set the tone. The four boundaries forced skipper Shreyas Iyer to replace Mayank with Axar Patel in third over. Arshdeep got the first breakthrough for India, cleaning up Kamil Pooran with a pitch-up delivery.

West Indies were dealt another blow in the sixth over when Shimron Hetmyer was run out while going for an unnecessary single.

It turned out to be double blow for the West Indies as Axar cleaned up Rovman Powell in the sixth over with a pitch-up delivery after the right-hander went for a huge heave over square-leg.

Sherfane Rutherford (56 off 34) gave the much needed impetus to West Indies' innings with the left-hander hitting Kuldeep Yadav for two sixes in the ninth over and then smashing Axar for two boundaries and a six in the 11th over.

Hope, who played the second fiddle after Rutherford's entry, departed in the 12th over after a nicely-crafted 52 off 37 balls. He was caught at deep mid-wicket by Axar off debutant Dhir's bowling.

Kuldeep then trapped Roston Chase plumb in front of the wicket as West Indies slipped to 114 for 5 in 12.3 overs.

After being clobbered over deep square leg for a maximum by Romario Shepherd, Dhir came back strongly to pick up his man, caught at long-off boundary by Tilak Varma.

Ishan Kishan then took a brilliant catch at deep mid-wicket off the bowling of Kuldeep to sent Rutherford packing.

Dhir picked up his third wicket in the form of Shamar Springer, caught by Axar at boundary with a toss up delivery after he was hit for a six in the earlier ball.

Returning to the set-up after an injury lay-off, pacer Mayank looked ordinary as he was taken to task by the West Indies batters before getting a wicket in the penultimate over in the form of Rutherford, caught by Dhir at deep square leg.

Axar completed the formalities, dismissing up Akeal Hosein, caught by Ishan at long on boundary. (*PTI*)

Test players retiring early for franchise is worry but can't fault them: MCC's Stewart



G UNNIKRISHNAN ■ Bengaluru

Cricketers retiring early from Tests to pursue franchise-based T20 leagues is a worry but they can't really be blamed for wanting to earn more by playing less, says Fraser Stewart, Head of Cricket at MCC — the global guardian of the Laws and Spirit of the game.

Stewart welcomed the International Cricket Council's recent decision to approve the usage of pink balls in daytime Tests on a trial basis to reduce the effect of fading light in the final session of the day. He believes it could spark fresh interest in the format and liberate it from the vagaries of nature.

"That's something that ICC, and I believe in a bilateral series — say, India playing Australia. It's for them to agree amongst themselves, for a particular game, are we going to use a pink ball?" Stewart responded to a PTI query. Stewart was in town to launch the Kannada edition of the Laws of Cricket app of Marylebone Cricket Club (MCC) in partnership with the Association of Cricket Umpires Karnataka (ACUK).

"Either they think there might be bad light, that it's going to cause a problem, or try to get more people in the ground so that they can come after work and you can get more people watching the Test match" Stewart elaborated.

"If both teams are happy to play with pink ball, perhaps, because they think it will mean that there can be more play because of bad weather, then it seems to make sense. Anything that means that there's more play and that more people can see the game, it makes sense," he added. (*PTI*)

Uruguay hammer India in Kolkata friendly as Anirudh Thapa provides lone bright spot

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Kolkata



Uruguay's Maximiliano Araujo, 20, scores a goal as India's Gurpreet Singh Sandhu looks on during an International friendly Football match between India and Uruguay, in Kolkata on Tuesday PTI

Uruguay produced a ruthless second-half display to hammer India 6-1 in their international friendly here on Tuesday, handing the hosts another heavy defeat against a two-time world champion side in space of three days.

Darwin Nunez put Uruguay ahead from the penalty spot in the 11th minute after Pramveer Singh was adjudged to have fouled Federico Vinas inside the box. India, however, responded impressively as Anirudh Thapa levelled in the 22nd minute, pouncing on a rebound after Ryan Williams' effort was parried by goalkeeper Thiago Cardozo.

Uruguay regained the lead in the 28th minute through Maximiliano Araujo, who finished from close range after India were caught out defensively. The game was briefly interrupted by lightning soon after the opening half-hour, but resumed after a weather-related stoppage.

India struggled to contain Uruguay's attacking quality after the break and Rodrigo Zalazar extended the visitors' advantage in the 53rd minute. Araujo then struck again six minutes later to make it 4-1, effectively putting the contest beyond the hosts.

Uruguay continued to exploit gaps in the Indian defence, with Juan Manuel Sanabria adding a fifth in the 71st minute before Rodrigo Aguirre completed the rout in 86th. The defeat capped a difficult international window for Khalid Jamil's side, who had drawn 1-1 with Panama before losing 0-4 to Brazil.



Ganguly returns to Delhi Capitals as head coach

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ New Delhi

Former India captain Sourav Ganguly was on Tuesday appointed as Delhi Capitals' head coach ahead of the 2027 Indian Premier League season, replacing Hemang Badani.

Ganguly's association with Delhi Capitals began in 2019 when he joined the franchise as an Advisor. Over the years, the 54-year-old has held multiple leadership positions across the Capitals ecosystem, including Director of Cricket for both the men's and women's teams.

He also served as the head coach at DC's SA20 outfit Pretoria Capitals last year. "I am looking forward to take on the role of Head Coach in the IPL. Delhi Capitals is a franchise very close to my heart, and one that I have shared a strong relationship with over the years," Ganguly said in statement shared by the franchise. "I have worked closely with the owners, management, support staff and players, which makes this an exciting responsibility for me. We have a talented group and have played a good brand of cricket in the recent past.

"I am looking forward to working with the squad, the new season, and building a strong and fearless team," he added.

Delhi Capitals is jointly owned by GMR Group and JSW Group. The two groups take turns managing the franchise in a biennial cycle. GMR's tenure ended in 2026.

Ganguly replaces Badani, under whom the Capitals failed to qualify for the playoffs in the past two seasons.

India, 6 other countries want to host 2036 Olympics: IOC

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Lausanne



The International Olympic Committee on Tuesday said India, Germany, Qatar and Turkiye are among seven countries with a stated interest in hosting the 2036 Olympics and have been invited to present their Games projects to the IOC's Future Host Commission next month.

The IOC said the projects will be assessed on a number of technical factors such as venue master-plan and athlete experience, funding strategy, political and public support, Games delivery capabilities, and legacy strategy to create long-term benefits for host communities. The world body, however, did not share the exact timeline for these presentations. "The Interested Parties currently in Continuous Dialogue with the IOC, with a stated interest in hosting the 2036 Olympic Games, are (in alphabetical order): Germany, Hungary, India, Qatar, Republic of Korea, South Africa and Turkiye," read a statement from the IOC.

"There are also a number of NOCs taking part in noncommittal talks with the IOC about hosting future Olympic Games beyond 2036. The Interested Parties have been invited to present their projects to the Future Host Commission in November," it added. The IOC keeping this schedule in view, said no other Interested Parties will be considered for 2036 after October 31.

Ahmedabad is India's city of choice to host the mega-event, which has never been held in the country before. India submitted its Expression of Interest to host the Games in 2024. The host selection process was subsequently halted by new IOC President Kirsty Coventry, who said fresh feedback would be taken from member nations to streamline the process.

M.P. MADHYA KSHETRA VIDYUT VITARAN CO. LTD.
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Nishtha Parisar, Bijlinagar, Govindpura, Bhopal-462023
Phone : 0755-2588291, E-mail : sepurchasebr@gmail.com
NIT No. :CGM/BR/02/Pur/6394 Bhopal, Dated : 06.10.2026

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER (OPEN TENDER)

E-tenders are invited from eligible bidders for following Work :-

TS No.	Particulars	Approx. Value of Stock inventory (In Cr.)	Tender Fee (In Rs.)	EMD (In Rs.)	Date of Opening of Bids Online
CGM/ BR/ TS-170	Insurance of Stock Inventory Material of MPMKVVCL Area Store Bhopal & Itarsi.	197.42 Crore	5,000/- + GST @ 18 % Extra	27,000/-	21.10.2026 at 15:30 Hrs.

Other details, terms and conditions are available on company website : **https://portal.mpcz.in & https://mptenders.gov.in** or the under signed office.
M.P. Madhyam/128401/2026 **CHIEF GENERAL MANAGER, BHOPAL REGION**